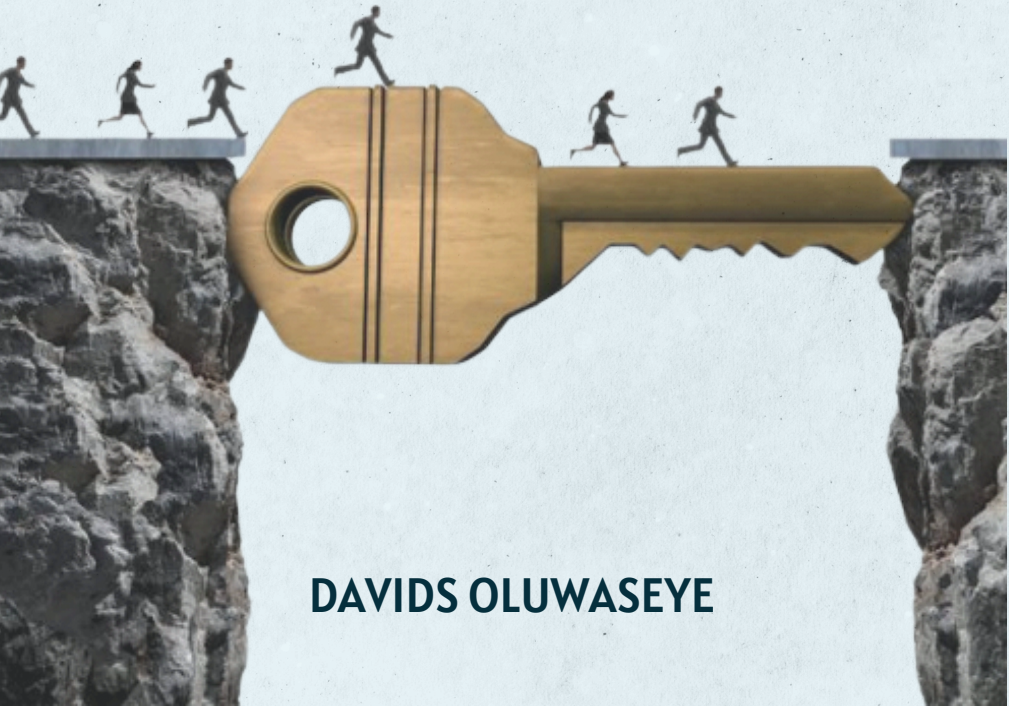
31 WISDOM KEYS



DAVIDS OLUWASEYE

31 Wisdom Keys

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Dedication

For in Him I live, and move, and have my being (Acts 17:28). This Book is dedicated to God the Giver of Wisdom.

Acknowledgement

This book was not just written, it was taught and lived. I have the privilege of mentoring an exceptional team of young men and women at different times on certain onsite and online platforms. It is relevant parts of the content that we taught over the years at these platforms that were worked into the Wisdom for Living Book Series, of which this book is the first. I want to appreciate these uncommon proteges and everyone at the Wisdom Place, House of Insights, and other platforms, most of whom were the first set of students to learn the insights contained in the pages of this book.

The importance of a purpose-driven team to any project cannot be overestimated. The resourceful team which kept me accountable, while doing their quota in ensuring the success of this book includes Precious Akintunde with whom I co-wrote this book. He has a lot of original ideas in various chapters of the book. The team of contributors and editors was led by Otiti Aburime and includes Precious Ojo, Precious Akintunde, Ifejesu Majua Odejide and Precious Abayowa who also did the design of this book. Most of the team members are also co-instructors with me at The Wisdom Place, The House of Insights and other platforms where I minister.

I do not trivialise the sacrifice of my family in allowing me to do all I do. To my ever loving wife, Oluwanifemi, thank you for your understanding and support. To my adorable sons, Wonders and Wisdom, your lives keep encouraging me never to give up.

To my mentors and various persons who have been instrumental in launching forth this ministry; Pst Sunday Okoh and Pst Temple Omolehin. Our pastors; Apostle Muyiwa Areo and Pastor Temitope Areo, we thank God for the gift of you.

I appreciate God the Father for His love, Jesus the Son, for His grace and the Lord Holy Spirit for His fellowship.

Davids Oluwaseye Ayodele

Preface

Proverbs 4:7 says ***wisdom is supreme; therefore get wisdom. Though it costs all you have, get understanding*** (NIV). The Word of God is unequivocal about the fact that without wisdom, one is hopeless, no matter what else one has. In everything God does, He operates with wisdom. Our revelation of God is not complete until we emphasise the wisdom dimension of Him.

The first thing that comes to mind when the average person thinks about God is how powerful He is, to do all He does. Truly, God is great in power and He desires His people to know and reveal His power. Have you ever wondered how wise God must be to do all He does? This tendency to lean towards celebrating power over wisdom is not because God has demonstrated more of His power than His wisdom, rather it is because humans by default, seem to attach more importance to the demonstration of power other than that of wisdom. Thus, if a person divides a sea supernaturally, passes through and closes it behind himself, leaving others behind, humans would for ever look at such a person in awe. However, if another taps into innovation and creativity to design and construct a bridge, opening a pathway for others to cross after him, he may not receive as much admiration as the first person even though what the second person has done is more beneficial to the people and enduring than the first.

This is to say that we must learn to place high value and honour for the demonstration of wisdom.

Oftentimes, power manifests by breaking natural laws, while wisdom manifests by riding on natural occurrences. However, we must know that both wisdom and power are the greatness of God in operation. Power and wisdom are both divine attributes that complement each other in the operations of God and as a child of God, you can and should have both. Thus, Jeremiah 10:12 says, *God has made the earth by His power, He has established the world by His wisdom and has stretched out the heavens at His discretion* (NKJV). God made the universe as a display of both His wisdom and power. Thus, Christ is revealed as both the power of God and the Wisdom of God (1 Corinthians 1:24).

This book is a compendium of different nuggets of wisdom gleaned from the principles of God revealed through His Word and His operations.

CHAPTER 1

THE SEVEN STREAMS OF WISDOM

Wisdom is multi-dimensional. It is possible to manifest wisdom in one area of life and display foolishness in another. Routinely take a look at the area of life where you struggle the most and you will have a good idea of the area where you are deficient in wisdom. A deficiency of wisdom in an area is not a bad situation, it is not seeking wisdom in one's area of lack that is bad. This is the reason the scripture says *if any of you lacks wisdom, he should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to him* (James 1:5). The worst wisdom problem is not foolishness; it is lacking wisdom and not seeking it. This is mostly due to pride or total oblivion of a higher reality and it is the reason Proverbs 26:12 says, *There is more hope for fools than for people who think they are wise.*

Generally, for the purpose of this book, we have identified seven streams of wisdom. We chose seven streams because there always seems to be something remarkable about giving seven points on something that amazes people. The truth is that there are seven variants of words in the Hebrew rendition of the Book of Proverb that are translated to mean wisdom; understanding, knowledge, discretion and other related words that show acumen. Proverbs 9:1 says, ***Wisdom has built her house; she has carved its seven columns. There are seven operations of the Spirit of God*** (Isaiah 11:2), and the Book of Revelation is replete with seven churches, seven candlesticks, seven stars, seven seals, seven trumpets, seven eyes and seven other things.

So, seven is the number of perfection. Permit me to postulate that perfect wisdom must cover the seven areas below:

1. **Spiritual Wisdom**: This is wisdom in the Word of God. It is absolute wisdom and understanding of spiritual laws. Spiritual wisdom makes one know what to do in the realm of the spirit to produce desired results in the natural. Spiritual wisdom is reflected in how well you know God and His principles. This is portrayed in Eph. 1:17, ***That the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory, may give unto you the spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of him,*** **and Col 1: 9 which says, '*Asking God, the glorious Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, to give you spiritual wisdom and insight so that you might grow in your knowledge of God*'.**
2. **Character Wisdom**: Conduct and behaviour could be a valid proof of wisdom or absence of it. The attitude, disposition, and approach of a wise person is different from that of a fool. Respect, manner of speech, courtesy, honour for people, diligence, attitude to work, etc. can reflect the level of wisdom a person has and vice versa. In all cultures, a person who behaves well is seen as wise and the one who behaves badly as foolish. This is because life itself is structured in a way that its laws promote and favour people who have good character while penalising those with bad character. Bad conduct is self-destructive and moral uprightness is the way of wisdom. This is different from spiritual wisdom because there are people who are not 'born again' or even 'spiritual' but have good character and they make progress in life.
3. **Relational Wisdom**: Managing and navigating relationships requires the skill of wisdom, very few people know that. Relational wisdom is simply having people skills. Lack of wisdom on how to manage relationships can lead to misuse and loss of vital relationships in one's life from spousal to familiar relationships, to business relationships and to general relationships.

The way a person manages relationships with people is oftentimes a measure of a dimension of wisdom in him or her.

4. **Practical/Pragmatic Wisdom:** This is the dimension of wisdom that is displayed in knowing how to manage affairs, make astute decisions and good judgement in everyday life especially in practical matters. Decisions like the ideal location to stay, the most suitable transportation for a journey, best terms in negotiation of a deal, where, when and how to make purchases, whether you should pay someone upfront before delivering your goods or not, and lots of other decisions demand practical discretion. Another word that describes pragmatic wisdom is "street smartness". Some people do not understand the importance of practical application of street wisdom to making decisions in everyday matters. Prov. 1:20-21 says, ***Wisdom shouts in the streets for a hearing. She calls out to the crowds along Main Street, and to the judges in their courts, and to everyone in all the land*** (TLB). Wisdom is found in the streets! Lack of practical street wisdom is the reason many naïve believers are conned and outsmarted by 'cunning' people every day. Lack of street wisdom in Nigerian parlance is called 'dulling yourself". 'Dulling yourself' is not spirituality. Practical wisdom is not imparted by religiosity or spirituality, it is as a result of sound exposure, calculated reason and sound understanding of the psychology of people and your environment. Practical wisdom is essential.

5. **Learning or Academic Wisdom:** Excellence in scholarly output is a measure of wisdom. It is clearly shown in scriptures that knowledge and understanding of ideas, concepts and books, good writing, reading, communication skills as well as sound analytical and cognitive reasoning, are a measure of wisdom. Dan. 1:17 shows how God ***gave four young men an unusual aptitude for understanding every aspect of literature and wisdom. And God gave Daniel the special ability to interpret the meanings of visions and dreams.*** Good academic and professional performance and prolific intellectual productivity are measures of wisdom.

6. **Entrepreneurial or Business Wisdom:** Enterprise and ability to build a profitable system is a measure of wisdom. Most believers have not come to terms with the importance of business wisdom; the ability to make the best financial and profit-oriented decision for continuity and sustainability of an enterprise. The wisdom of buying and selling, capitalizing on opportunities, building wealth and generating income, dealing with people with shrewd sense is called business wisdom. Business wisdom, most times, is practical wisdom in the business scene. It is not always developed in business school. According to 1 Kings 10:4-5, ***And when the queen of Sheba had seen all the wisdom of Solomon, the house that he had built, 5 the food on his table, the seating of his servants, the service of his waiters and their apparel, his cupbearers, and his entryway by which he went up to the house of the Lord, there was no more spirit in her.*** Solomon manifested business and organisational wisdom in addition to all the other streams of wisdom that he had.

7. **Skill/Technical Wisdom:** There is a dimension of wisdom that shows itself as creativity, skill and ability to do things with aptitude and proficiency. Wisdom in that area of skill is usually as a result of God given grace and love for that field.

Ex 31:1-6 says, ***The Lord also said to Moses, "See, I have appointed Bezalel (son of Uri, and grandson of Hur, of the tribe of Judah), and have filled him with the Spirit of God, giving him great wisdom, ability, and skill in constructing the Tabernacle and everything it contains. He is highly capable as an artistic designer of objects made of gold, silver, and bronze. He is skilled, too, as a jeweler and in carving wood. "And I have appointed Oholiab (son of Ahisamach of the tribe of Dan) to be his assistant; moreover, I have given special skill to all who are known as experts, so that they can make all the things I have instructed you to make.*** (TLB). Tech savviness, musical dexterity, unmatched sport prowess, artistic finesse and mastery, and technical knack are often expressions of wisdom in a specific area.

This wisdom is oftentimes God-given and natural but could also be developed. Even when natural, it still needs to be cultivated.

CHAPTER 2

THE WISDOM OF FOCUSED VISION

Vision is the ideation in your mind of a desired future reality. It is a prerequisite for success in life. When there is no vision, life becomes a guess work and leads nowhere. Prov. 29:18 says, **'when there is no vision, people cast off restraint…'** Thus, whenever you see someone living an 'anything-goes' kind of life, you just met someone with no life vision. Visionary people know where they are going and constrain their lives only to activities and engagements that take them there.

It is important to note that vision is beyond having an ambition to become something. Having life ambitions has been popularised among young people especially in our schools, but it is important to teach Kingdom citizens that life vision is not just the career one desires to succeed at. It is the assignment God has given you for your life. There is no harm in people of the world developing a life ambition and pursuing it, but for a child of God, genuine one's life vision should be God-inspired. This is because success in the Kingdom is not merely measured by material accomplishment, but by fulfilling one's God-given assignment. Your vision is a mind-picture of your life purpose. Knowing and pursuing God's vision for your life is a foundational wisdom for living.

Focusing on your life vision is a master secret to greatness in life. Have you ever been to an artist's studio and observed the level of focus with which he creates his masterpiece? Why does a carpenter focus with precision as he hits nails held between his fingers?

Why this level of care? Because the slightest misuse of the hammer can cost him his fingers. So, for the carpenter to achieve his carpentry goals and also to avoid injuries on his finger, he will engage the wisdom of focus. Focus has been defined by someone as 'Following on Course Until Success'.

Having understood clearly what your life assignment and vision is, you need to focus on fulfilling it. Focus starts by preparing yourself for the future you have seen in your mind. Note that during the time of preparation for your vision, there are lots of distractions. For example, someone may have a vision of becoming a great musician and is a soccer lover. While both music and soccer are harmless past times, such person needs to know which one is the vision and which is the distraction. Thus, he may need to regulate the time spent on soccer and pour more time into musical rehearsals, if he is serious about becoming a "world class musician". There is also a need for focus when one has fully stepped into one's vision. At this point, there are lots of compromises calling for attention; focus is keeping the main thing as the main thing. It is wise to minimise goals per time. Do not just have a long list of goals that spread your life thin, rather prioritise and pursue your goals in order of importance and impact on your vision. This will prevent you from dissipating your energy haphazardly and help you to get desired results in life.

The Bible instructs in Prov. 4:25 (Amp) ***"Let your eyes look right on [with fixed purpose], and let your gaze be straight before you".*** What are you aiming to shoot? Even if you have the best of all bows and the finest of all arrows; and you are the most skilled of all archers; you need focus! You only shoot well when you focus well on your target. An unfocused shot will only make one expend energy unto futility, resulting in an unprofitable use of time. Focused vision will help you make the best use of your time, and productive use of your energy.

A resolution you should make every day of your life is to remain firm, unbending and dogged as you go about actualizing your vision.

Exercises.

What is your vision?

_____

_____

_____

What are the principles to help you gain focus in your vision?

_____

_____

_____

CHAPTER 3

THE WISDOM OF SELF EVALUATION

Living an unappraised life is great folly. Periodic evaluation and routine check-up of every area of your life is great wisdom. Many people do things repeatedly without even pausing to check whether they are getting the intended results from doing those things. It is commonly said that doing the same thing repeatedly and expecting a different result is folly. Well, living an unappraised life is what makes people continue doing things without reconsideration.

Every time you are not living your desired life or getting the desired outcome, take a look at your life and activities you engage in and find out what is not been done rightly. Don't be quick to allocate blame for non-working areas of your life to other people, situation, national problems, enemies and devils. Those external factors affect everybody and some are still getting results despite these factors. So, what do you need to change or do differently? What do you need to learn? Periodic self-evaluation is a necessity for a successful life. Retreats and vacations should not only be periods for rest, prayers or family get-together, they should also be time to be alone and review your life, years and destiny , to check what is working and what is not working, what needs to be sustained and what needs to be changed.

2Cor.13.5 says, ***Examine and test and evaluate your own selves to see whether you are holding to your faith and showing the proper fruits of it. Test and prove yourselves [not Christ].***

Do you not yourselves realize and know [thoroughly by an ever-increasing experience] that Jesus Christ is in you—unless you are [counterfeits] disapproved on trial and rejected? (AMP). The Message Version puts it this way***; test yourselves to make sure you are solid in the faith. Don't drift along taking everything for granted. Give yourselves regular checkups. You need firsthand evidence, not mere hearsay, that Jesus Christ is in you. Test it out. If you fail the test, do something about it.*** (MSB)

In the Creation Account in Gen 1, after every day of creation, it is written … '**and God saw what He created that it was good'.** This shows that God daily appraised His output at creation and marked each day satisfactory. Self-appraisal should be an everyday task. At the end of the day, check how the day went, where you wasted time, things you wrote you were going to do and you did not do, things you should not have done or said that you did say and do, then make decisions to improve on your short comings.

Apart from daily self-evaluation, there should also be times when you take time off from the hustle-bustle of life just for the purpose of a more robust and intensive self-appraisal. In this period, you take a look at the life goals that you have set before now, inspect them and see where you have performed poorly in all honesty, then make those areas a priority going forward. An unexamined life is a life pre-disposable to error. Engage the Wisdom of Self-Examination today.

EXERCISE

Area of Life	What are my goals (for the year, period under consideration or lifetime)	How well am I faring in attaining these goals?	What do I need to do differently?
Spiritual Life/ Relationship with God			
Relationships/ Family			
Finances/Money Management			
Purpose/Vision /Ministry			
Career/Work/ Business			

CHAPTER 4

THE WISDOM OF AUTOMATION

Greatness is a cumulus of simple but consistent routines that develop over time. The most valid factor to vet greatness is to check the track record of the routines that led to it. Automated routine is the genius of greatness. Wise and exceptional people have learnt the secret of automating the routines that account for their success in life.

Most people do great things here and there. Nearly everybody works out once in a while, reads a good book, takes a daring step to move forward when they are pressured by life, or creatively solves problems as the occasion presents. However, the difference between exceptional people and average people is that great people consistently do the great things that average people do once in a while.

To think about it, most students, including those with low academic grade points, have gotten a good grade in at least a course at some point. However, the first-class student does not get distinction once in a while; he/she gets an 'A' grade as a routine. If you want to know how great your life will be, check your routines. If you want to be successful and great, automate the routines that make for greatness in life. Automating your daily life for success is great wisdom.

When God created the heavens and the earth, he ordered and automated the daily running of the universe. According to Gen 1: 14,

Then God said, ***"Let there be lights in the firmament of the heavens to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs and seasons, and for days and years.'***

God has never needed to create another daybreak since the first; He does not command the day to break every morning and set every evening. From creation, He automated the dawn of the day and the dusk of the night. These routines automatically run by God's initial command. Psalm 148: 5 says, ***God established them forever and forever. His orders will never be revoked.*** Have you ordered your yearly, monthly, weekly or daily routine in such a way that it runs automatically to deliver all round success?

The signature of the wisdom of automation is seen everywhere in nature. Since God created the first fruit and herb, He has never had to revisit to create another. He automated a system for reproduction in all living things. Thus Genesis 8:22 says, ***"While the earth remaineth, seedtime and harvest, and cold and heat, and summer and winter, and day and night shall not cease."***

The Law of Automation is the master key to consistency and commitment. When there is an automated routine that you live up to, your life performance is not left to mood or chance. Many people are largely regulated by emotions which vacillate irregularly. So, a person makes a decision for greatness and draws out goals and disciplines he needs to pursue and get fulfilled. But, at the very next moment, he has wandered off the goal and suddenly becomes so indifferent to the pursuit of the goals he had set. Why? It is because he is being regulated by situations, emotions and emergencies of life. It is wise for your life to be regulated by routines and systems.

The following are some things to automate into your life for success:

1. Have a daily prayer time : You can achieve this either by having prayer times or periods. You can also have a community or accountability group that you join to pray at particular times.

2. Have a study program: have books that you are reading weekly or monthly and even courses you take monthly or quarterly - write all these out from the beginning of the year.

3. Automate impact by having a platform that runs periodically and perpetually where you dispense value either for profit or non-profit.

4. Automate financial savings and investment by having a percentage of your income set aside for your future.

5. Automate money making habits: Either by writing on a blog, selling products, curating promo packages that you can run at special periods etc.

6. Automate your waking up time and morning rituals: exercises, meditation, prayers, listening to motivation or sermons etc.

7. Automate rest: siesta, vacation or retreat time daily, weekly, monthly or yearly as applicable.

8. Automate time spent with loved ones either daily, weekly or monthly dates, picnics, family time at meals etc.

Exercise.

Write out some automated daily, weekly or monthly routines for the following areas of your life:

1. Spiritual

2. Mental

3. Professional

4. Academic

5. Financial

6. Physical/Health

7. Relationships

CHAPTER 5

THE WISDOM OF ORDER

Order is doing the right thing at the right time in the right place. Order is the harbinger of excellence. In fact, excellence has been defined as attaining the highest level of order in a particular venture. Order is paying attention to details and making sure everything is as it ought to be. An orderly life is the requirement for growth, greatness and productivity. Anything that is out of order saps energy and waste effort. You must make sure you live an ordered life.

God is obsessed with order and proper arrangement. When we study how God paid attention to details at creation, we'll know that he is a God of order. The orderliness of the skies, the stars, the seasons, the water-cycle, carbon-cycle, and nature shows that God is a stickler for order. Wherever we see disorder in nature, man has interfered. Order is when all parts of something whole stay where they should and work together harmoniously for a desirable outcome. Order is a signature of God.

1 Cor. 14:40 says ***let all things be done decently and in order.*** No one should act disorderly in the name of being spiritual. Even in Church meetings, there is what is called the order of service. Meaning even the service, ruled and directed by the Holy Spirit should have an order. Many Christians do not plan or put order in place and hide under the pretext that they will do 'as the Spirit leads'.

While it is true that the Holy Spirit might break or disrupt human order when He starts moving, He is not an enemy of order. The Holy Spirit loves order and many times, might even demand for order to be in place before He blesses or moves upon something.

The book of Numbers is an Old Testament classic on order. God ordered the position where everything was to be put. He specified the dressing for every priest and for every person that was to carry out a task for Him. He was clear on who was in charge of every assignment and gadget in the Tabernacle and in the entire nation of Israel. He gave details on where each tribe was to camp and who was to move first when they were to start a journey and those to stop first when it was time to rest. God left nothing to chance, He gave sitting arrangement, dressing arrangement, movement instructions, allocated tasks, responsibility and position and insisted that everyone do what they are supposed to do without breaking order. God is obsessed with order. Living an orderly life is Godlikeness.

Another striking order in the Book of Number is the orderly documentation of every fact. The details with which the statistics of the civilization which lived thousands of year were recorded and kept till date shows that order is a divine wisdom that only God gives and is not necessarily acquired through school education. Many educated individuals and organisations do not have the level of facts, figures and statistics that the primitive nation of Israel provided and preserved till date about all the records and details of their nation and journey. Truly, order is a God-given wisdom and is not merely human taught. This is why it is right to pray for the wisdom to be orderly in all areas of life.

In African parlance, a disorderly life is called an “anyhow life’ or ‘anything goes’ lifestyle. Disorderly people are always threatened by order and they fight it.

Order or disorder shows in a person's gait, grooming, dressing, speech, driving and working. When order is put in place and a particular person or people complain and love to violate order in that environment, you have met a person who is naturally disorderly and wants the environment to take their own shape. It is lack of a structure of order around one's life that gets many people into the troubles they get into. Disorder is the reason anybody enters into your private space anyhow. Some people are so disorderly that nearly all friends and acquaintances have access to their bedroom - worst still, their unkempt bedroom. Part of order is demarcating and drawing lines around your life to know who belongs where and who cannot have access to certain things and places in your life and space. Whether kept or unkempt, there are spaces in your life and environment that should be demarcated as non-public.

Another area of order is time management. It is disorder that makes a person, a meeting or an organization always run late. Let's be orderly in managing time and doing what is only proper for the time. It is disorderly to receive a person who did not book an appointment and gist for hours because he/she said they was passing by and thought to say 'hi' to you. Order shows in the arrangement of our environment. One way to know an orderly people is to examine their homes ,offices and private spaces.

1 Tim 3:2 says, ***for a pastor must be a good man whose life cannot be spoken against. He must have only one wife, and he must be hard working and thoughtful***, ORDERLY, ***and full of good deeds***. . . (TLB)
A leader must be orderly in conduct and behaviour. An unruly conduct and conversation is the foolishness of disorder. Behave orderly and speak like a gentleman and lady with sound etiquette. Another area where order cannot be overlooked is in dressing. Going through the Bible, we see that God is specific about dressing for His people. Indecent and immoral dressing is wrong by all ramifications and is disorderly for a leader, most especially a Christian.

Nudity is not a virtue, neither is dressing unruly. Have you ever watched the United Nations proceedings and seen presidents in torn-jeans, with low hanging belts, tattoos and diamond chains around their necks? What about secretaries of state wearing revealing spaghetti wears with low hanging-cleavage-reveal-sleeveless shirts on butt-tight miniskirts? Some things are not issues of religious talks but honour, order and etiquette. Also, stone-age dressing, tattered, pauperised dressing, uncultured dressing and unfashionable dressing are neither glorifying. Excellent dressing is part of order, let's be orderly.

The level of order in your personal life dictates the order in your organization and work. Do you know that order that you develop in your personal hygiene and grooming, home and office arrangement, and general daily life will spill over to your work, career, enterprise and business. Every organization and platform generally assumes the level of order demonstrated by its members, especially the leader(s).

A strong determinant of organizational order is the flow of authority within the organization. There cannot be order within a people and an organization until there is clear cut definition of who is answerable to who, who has authority to dictate to who and who must honour and submit to who. There must also be clear-cut and non-clashing job descriptions for every person in the organization. The truth is that an organization – nation, business, ministry, government or non-governmental cannot grow beyond the level of order it puts in place. One of the highest duties of leadership is to put and maintain order.

Order is important in our personal lives and in the way we do things. Proper order in doing things talks about the do and don'ts in methodologies of things. Do not just put good order in place in your personal life, let everything you do be according to due order.

There is proper order in communication lines in an organization. There is due order in business communication and it is different from informal conversation. There is a right order in relating with the opposite gender, There is also due order in ministry as regards relating with the people and resources God commits in your hands. Whenever people violate order, they incur grave consequences. 1 Chron. 15:13 says, ***For because you did not do it the first time, the Lord our God broke out against us, because we did not consult Him about the proper order*** (NKJV). In this scripture, they were doing a good thing but someone lost his life because he violated the order of how it ought to be done. It is not enough to know what to do, you must find out how to do it and the proper order that governs doing it. You can never get favour and approval in a place or with a person that you violate the laid down order. Following laid down order is one of the fastest ways to secure favour with a person or group.

CHAPTER 6

THE WISDOM OF SOLITUDE

Though it may not be a conventional knowledge, a secret strategy that every great and visionary person should engage is the Wisdom of Solitude - being alone and going alone when occasion demands. Have you noticed that most of the activities that involve the highest level of personal productivity need a level of solitude for appropriate focus? Prayer, studying, practising a skill, meditating, writing and a host of other exercises that are important for life progress, need one to be alone to do them effectively. Even when such activities are to be done publicly with others, it is how well each individual have mastered them privately that determines how well they do them publicly.

What a person does with their solitary time is often a direct reflection of the person's confidence, vision, character and productivity. A leader, most especially, must learn to take time to be alone to think, plan and work creatively. Every leader knows that eagles do not fly in a flock; they soar solo: It is sparrows, chicks and ducks that always need company before they can have the confidence to move. The sad truth is that some people are such bad company that they cannot even be their own company. they always need someone else's 'better company'. A leader cannot afford to live with a flock mentality - doing things with everyone else and doing only what is done by everyone else.
It is important to know when to be with the crowd and when to retreat from the crowd.

This is because there are some things that one will not have access to unless one takes off time to 'download' them in the secret place. Matt 10:27 says, ***What I tell you in the dark, speak in the daylight; what is whispered in your ear, proclaim from the roofs.*** This shows that the things that will proclaim you on the rooftops of life are the things you heard or did privately. Luke 8: 17 also reiterates, For nothing is secret, that shall not be made manifest; neither any thing hid, that shall not be known and come abroad. The great things you are doing privately are the things that have the ability to announce and make you manifest to your world.

Part of the Wisdom of Solitude is making periodic retreats an integral part of your life. There will always be perpetual demands on you as a leader which will look like you can't get away from them. However, the truth is that if you are drained and burnout, all the people will leave you and look for an alternative. This is the reason it is wise to periodically retreat from the hustle and bustle of life, the pressures, demands of life and the demands of the people to go and refuel your spirit, soul, body and vision in the place of solitude. The rule of the thumb for the mindset of retreating into solitude is to remember that "there is no one that is so indispensable that the world will fall apart when he is temporarily unavailable."

It is also worthy of note that everyone that did great things in this life had a season of their life when they willingly or without much choice had to be in protracted solitude. In Exodus 3:1-4, there is the record of Moses' encounter with God that launched him into destiny. ***'Now Moses was tending the flock of Jethro, his father-in-law, the priest of Midian, and he led the flock to the far side of the desert and came to Horeb, the mountain of God. There the angel of the Lord appeared to him in flames of fire from within a bush. Moses saw that though the bush was on fire it did not burn up. So Moses thought, "I will go over and see this strange sight — why the bush does not burn up."***

When the Lord saw that he had gone over to look, God called to him from within the bush, "Moses! Moses!". The truth is that most encounters that will change a person's life dramatically and forever will be experienced in the secret place. It is important to note that God does not only encounter people in the open and in corporate meeting but solitude. Truthfully, there are things that God only does to people on an individual level. Many public encounters are to drive people into the place of solitude where the work of God in their lives continues.

The story of Moses period of solitude did not start at the bushing bush, it dates into his forty years of sheep rearing alone in the wilderness. He was chosen by God for the great task of leading Israel out of bondage in Egypt. He was a public figure in the palace limelight in Egypt and wanted to achieve his destiny on the strength of that positioning. However, he failed in the mission. It was after he was exiled and had learned a lot through the practice of the wisdom of solitude that he was ready for God's commissioning. Great destinies are not prepared for in the public but in the private incubator of solitude. This is the reason after Moses started his life mission; he was already addicted to being alone with God in His presence. He spent a cumulative of 80 days alone with God on the mountain. What is birthed in the secret place of being alone with God will also be sustained in the secret place of being alone with God.

God will not give a person a crucial task unless the person is established in the details of the assignment. These details and instructions are received in the secret place where the leader and visionary communes with the Spirit of God and writes the instructions of the vision(s). This is expressed in Prov. 18:1 which says, ***through desire a man, having separated himself, seeketh and intermeddleth with all wisdom***

David had his share of encounters in solitude. In fact, the confidence he

had to face Goliath was developed from the victories he had won when he fought in solitude. According to 1 Samuel 17:34-37, ***David said to Saul, "Your servant has been keeping his father's sheep. When a lion or a bear came and carried off a sheep from the flock, I went after it, struck it and rescued the sheep from its mouth. When it turned on me, I seized it by its hair, struck it and killed it.*** David built capacity for great exploits in the secret and when it was time for him to manifest, he did so seamlessly. Your public victory is determined by your secret diligence. Success is not attained in front of the crowd but in the private place of preparation. The truth is that the higher one progresses through life and in leadership, the more difficult it becomes to create time off the legitimate demands of life to seek God, develop one's self and grow. It is only those that are already addicted to the secret place that keep making out time to be alone with God and to grow irrespective of how busy the demands of life become.

The necessity of solitude for greatness seems to be consistent with scriptures. It is one of God's secret strategies for forging his choice instruments. God would isolate them, work on them, build and equip them before He opens the door of manifestation for them. If you seem to be in a season when you are alone with God and the public lights are not on you, then you should know you are in good company.

When Paul was called, he first wanted to start public manifestation immediately but he met resistance. In fact, even without resistance, he might not have had the level of success he eventually had. This is because the resistance and persecution he experienced made him retreat to Arabia and later to Damascus. He also spent some time in his hometown Tarsus and later in Antioch where he spent years praying and growing alongside some other people (Acts 13:2). It was after many years of his conversion that he was eventually commissioned by God into the ministry.

No one succeeds in a great venture until they have paid their dues in ample time of growth and development in the season of oblivion.

It is noteworthy that the final announcement of a person who has been vetted in solitude is completely within God's sovereignty and jurisdiction. Do not be overly bothered with leaving the secret place of preparation to the limelight of manifestation. When God sees your diligence in the secret and how you have laboured to build capacity in the secret, God Himself will announce you and people will SEE you. every grace and anointing that God has put in you will become visible to men and people will start placing demand on God's grace on your life. Remember Luke 8:16-17 ***'No man, when he hath lighted a candle, covereth it with a vessel, or putteth it under a bed; but setteth it on a candlestick, that they which enter in may see the light. For nothing is secret, that shall not be made manifest; neither any thing hid, that shall not be known and come abroad'***. If man will not keep forever in secret a candle they light, how much more will God put on an exalted place a person He has lighted in the place of solitude.

Ultimately, Jesus Christ was a master practitioner of the wisdom of solitude.
The next mention about Jesus after the stories surrounding His birth was when He was twelve years. Thereafter, He was in oblivion till he was thirty years. This season was definitely not idled away; it was spent in diligent preparation. When Jesus showed up on the scene at the age of thirty, He was baptised and the Holy Spirit came upon Him. Immediately, after being filled with the Holy Spirit, he was again led by the Spirit into the wilderness where he was alone in the wilderness for 40 days and nights and there had encounters that chartered His destiny and ministry. The concept of being alone to have life and destiny encounters is an indisputable trend in the scripture.

After Jesus returned from the place of solitude in the wilderness, scripture says that ***"Then Jesus returned in the power of the Spirit to Galilee…"*** (Luke 4:14)

Everyone who aspires to be great must learn the act of withdrawing into solitude. Great people chase the secret place and not the stage because in the kingdom. The place of solitude is also the secret place. The secret place is where God meets with man individually and privately, that is to say that the secret place is not in the church or at a prayer meeting even though God is in those gatherings too.

Jesus set the precedence of valuing the secret place for all believers. Thus, after He started ministry, he periodically withdrew into the secret place until the final moments in Gethsemane where He was alone with God to prepare for the cross (Matt 26: 36 - 38). In fact, Jesus counted periodic withdrawal into solitude so important that he had to school His disciples in the Art and Wisdom of Solitude. In Luke 9:10-11, ***Then the apostles returned, they reported to Jesus what they had done. Then he took them with him and they withdrew by themselves to a town called Bethsaida, but the crowds learned about it and followed him.*** Luke 5:16 ***says, But Jesus often withdrew to the wilderness for prayer. Also in*** John 6:15-16***, Jesus, knowing that they intended to come and make him king by force, withdrew again to a mountain by himself.***

Jesus constantly practised the Wisdom of Solitude and so should you.

CHAPTER 7

THE WISDOM OF BUILDING

Wisdom is required in building anything commendable. Prov. 24: 3 says, ***through skillful and godly wisdom is a house (a life, a home, a family, an enterprise, a business, a ministry, an organisation) built, and by understanding it is established (on a sound and good foundation).***
(AMP Version, some additions, mine). Anywhere you see anything well built, wisdom was employed. Wisdom is justified by what it builds. If you want to build anything that men will see and commend, you must be intentional about using wisdom. .
In 1 Cor. 3: 10, Paul says, ***by the grace given to me, I laid a foundation as a wise builder, and someone else is building on it. But each one should build with care.*** The level of wisdom of a person can be determined by the quality of what he has built or is building with his or her life. Do not just live from day to day, let the daily activities of your life be cumulative in building something specific. Whatever you are building must be related to your goals. Your activities, time, resources investment and spiritual/mental exertion must revolve round what you are building. You must go through life with the mindset of a builder.

The following are things to build with your lifetime:
1. **Build a relationship with God**: Good relationships do not just happen, they are deliberately built. Time is a major ingredient for building a relationship. Another key component in building a good relationship is prioritisation.

Many legitimate things will compete for your time and attention, but, for you to build a relationship with God, you have to deliberately plan and prioritize times of prayer, meditation, study of God's word, fellowshipping with other believers, serving and impacting people for God. It is wisdom to always create time for God no matter how busy you get.

2. **Build people:** A life lived for one's self alone is an unfulfilled one. You must have a set of people you are building and raising. The people you build today will be your reward tomorrow. Opportunity to build people abounds in every area of life and irrespective of location. There are both online and onsite platforms for impacting people. Do not just live a life of surviving day to day and earning to make a living, have people you are building and be intentional about it.

3. **Build a Financial System:** An employee cannot transfer their employed job to their progeny but they can transfer ownership of business they built. This shows us that it is only what you build that you ever really own. It is great wisdom to build a business. While it is not everyone that might have the skill and training to succeed as an entrepreneur, some will succeed as intrapreneurs. However it is most important that everyone owns a financial system that you can pass over as a legacy. This could be a business, an investment or an income generating asset. Prov. 27: 24 says ***develop your business first before building your house*** (NLT).

4. **Build a family:** Family is God's provision for giving and receiving love. Even the All-Wise God built a big universal family where He is 'Father'. Family brings accountability, responsibility and sanity to a life. It is a wise thing to build a family.

5. **Build a Good Name:** Build a reputation for yourself. Prov. 22: 2 says ***a good name is rather to be chosen than great riches and loving favour rather than silver and gold.*** It is important to build a name that will be an asset to open doors for people. Let the mention of your name be an access key to people. You must also be deliberate on putting a name and a brand on things you do. Many people do fantastic things but without the consciousness of building a name. Have a name for that venture, meeting or platform where you dispense value to a few people. Things grow better when they have a name. Many times, the greatness you seek is in the greatness of the name of that thing you are building. So God told Abraham, "I will make you a great nation, I will bless you and make your name great". Enoch Adeboye existed as an unknown name until Christ the Redeemer's Ministries/Redeemed Christian Church of God was built to become a great ministry. Bill Gates became a great name because Microsoft became a great company. Whether in the spiritual or corporate realms, the law is the same; your greatness is linked to the greatness of the name or brand you are building. Note that you may be either the pioneer or the associate in the name you are building, it does not really matter. David Abioye is a great name because Living Faith was built to greatness even though he is not the president of the organisation. If you are not a pioneer, it is strategic to consider the greatness and goodwill or the potentials of a name in deciding where to affiliate yourself.

6. **Build a House**: it is a blessing to own your home. Do not be comfortable as a tenant, no matter how nice your landlord or house-agent is. The amount some people spend on a rented apartment and luxury is alarming when they do not have a land or home to their own name anywhere. Build houses to rent to others and own your own home. The earlier you build a house, the better.

We must believe God for a new flow of God's blessing where the majority of His children own their own houses as young people even before marriage.

7. **Build a Platform:** There should be a platform where you dispense value to the world. A platform is a meeting point between you and people for the purpose of exchange of value. Do not just work for the sake of earning a livelihood all through life. Make sure you build a platform for dispensing your inherent values to people. Most times, your platform is the stream and the determinant of your rewards in life. It could be physical or virtual, but make sure there is a platform that you have built to deliver and dispense your inherent giftings to the world. A platform could be a ministry, business, charity organisation, etc. It is very good and profitable to join an existing platform. However, it is also powerful to create your own platform, even if it is as a subset or as a complementary set to the platform you joined. In other words, it is okay to join an existing system, but the platform must afford you the opportunity to dispense your individual contribution in a way that you are also positioned for reward. In some cases, it is possible and wise to create a platform that runs uniquely, uncompetitively and simultaneously with the platform you are part of.

8. **Build wealth:** There is a difference between making money and building wealth. To build wealth, you must carefully amalgamate a portfolio of multiple streams of income for consistent inflow and growth of wealth. Wealth building demands that there are financial streams that bring consistent cash flow to you so that you are never short of money to meet your immediate expenditure. At the same time they are streams that are able to do capital projects so that you can advance financially through targeted gains.

Different streams of income includes: wages from job/work, profits from business/sales, dividends from investments and paper, royalties and honorariums from impact or one-time products, rentals from assets/real estates, etc. Creating wealth is strategically diversifying your i streams of income and investments so that your finances grow sustainably and consistently. According to Prov. 13:22 , ***a good man leaves an inheritance to his children's children.***

9. **Build a legacy:** Building a legacy is very vital in life. What will you bequeath to the generation coming after you? Leaving a legacy is not just leaving behind money or assets for your children. Building a legacy is building all of the above named points such that when you retire from active service or leave the earth, there is something tangible that your life has produced and future generations received as a proof of your life well lived.

Exercise

Write down three things you will build in the following timelines:

Now till the next 5 years

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

5 to 10 years

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

10 to 25 years

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

25 to 50 years

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

50 years till lifetime

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

CHAPTER 8

THE WISDOM OF OWNERSHIP

The total land expanse on earth is 13.003 billion hectares while as at January 1, 2023, the world population according to the United Nations is 8,045,311,447. It can be implied from these figures that if land was to be shared equally to all inhabitants of the earth, each person is entitled to approximately 1.616 hectares of land. While this is far from what is obtainable due to many other factors that affect individual access to available land, the fact still remains that our God is a God of abundance and everyone on earth has divine right to a wide expanse of land by God's design.

Investing in owning a land is a timeless wisdom key. In fact, ownership of things on earth is God's principle for man. God introduced himself as the Owner of Heaven and Earth and He desires that we are owners on earth. Ps 115:15-16 says: ***May you be blessed by the Lord, Who made heaven and earth. The heaven, even the heavens, are the Lord's; But the earth He has given to the children of men.***

God is neither renting nor leasing heaven; He is Owner and He wants you to be an owner as well. Ps 24:1-2 ***declares the earth is the Lord's, and everything in it, the world, and all who live in it; for he founded it upon the seas and established it upon the waters.*** God confidently declares in Ps 50:10-12, ***Every beast of the forest is mine, and the cattle upon a thousand hills. I know all the fowls of the mountains:***

and the wild beasts of the field are mine. If I were hungry, I would not tell thee: for the world is mine, and the fullness thereof. He is the Creator and one of His appellations in the scripture is 'The Possessor of Heaven and Earth' (Gen 14: 19,22)

One of the blessings of Abraham is ownership. When God called Abraham in Gen 12, He gave him the blessing and promised him ownership of land (Gen 12: 1-3, 7). Additionally, in Gen 17:4-8, God spoke to Abraham, ***As for me, behold, my covenant is with thee, and thou shalt be a father of many nations. Neither shall thy name any more be called Abram, but thy name shall be Abraham; for a father of many nations have I made thee. And I will make thee exceeding fruitful, and I will make nations of thee, and kings shall come out of thee. And I will establish my covenant between me and thee and thy seed after thee in their generations for an everlasting covenant, to be a God unto thee, and to thy seed after thee. And I will give unto thee, and to thy seed after thee, the land wherein thou art a stranger, all the land of Canaan, for an everlasting possession; and I will be their God.***
God could have blessed Abraham with the covenant of prosperity and greatness and all the other things He promised without making him the possessor of land. However, He knew the blessing was not complete until He blessed him with ownership of land. Ownership is God's blessing and you must aspire to own things, lands, buildings, assets, businesses, industries e.t.c Your greatness and wealth is connected to what you own. Wealth ranking in the world is not done by measuring liquid cash in banks, but assets owned by the people. Ownership is wealth.

Everyone should aspire to own vital things in their lifetime. Own businesses, land, your home, real estate investment, grounds for your business/work, vehicles, and structures.

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Everyone should aspire to own vital things in their lifetime. Own businesses, land, your home, real estate investment, grounds for your business/work, vehicles, and structures.

Ownership is a blessing: even though there are things that are economically cheaper when leased than owned. However, many times, the issue of ownership goes beyond mere financial bottom-line. It goes into the spirit of our spiritual right as children of God. Thus, when it comes to dealing with things that are cheaper to lease than to own; it is still better to own those things and make money from leasing out some parts of its use to offset the additional cost of ownership. For instance, someone may argue that it makes more economic sense for him/her to use public transport than to own a car. While that may be very true, the blessing of ownership is beyond financial calculations, it goes into the spirit of freedom, liberty and spiritual blessing. Therefore, it is financially smart to own a car and then factor out a way to make money from it through commercialising some parts of one's use of the car so that the additional income can offset some parts of the cost of ownership. Ownership is ultimately always wise than renting.

Psalms 44:3 ***For they got not the land in possession by their own sword, neither did their own arm save them: but thy right hand, and thine arm, and the light of thy countenance, because thou hadst a favour unto them***. We must believe in ownership through God's favour. If you must work for everything you will own, you will work for long years before owning vital things. It was a norm in Africa for people to work in civil service for 35 years and build a house from their retirement gratuity. The sad thing is that by this time, many of their children are leaving the house to start their own life, also renting somewhere and the cycle continues. So, the children are never blessed by the ownership. It takes God's favour to own things early in life and that is what we must gun for.

When Abraham was to bury Sarah in Genesis 23, he needed a piece of land in the country where he stayed. The land was owned by Ephron the Hittite and he was willing to lease it to Abraham for free.

However, Abraham demanded that he would buy it for use. According to Genesis 23:10 16, Now Ephron . . . answered Abraham . . . **"No, my lord, hear me: I give you the field and the cave that is in it; I give it to you in the presence of the sons of my people. I give it to you. Bury your dead!"** Then Abraham bowed himself down before the people of the land; and he spoke to Ephron in the hearing of the people of the land, saying, **"If you will give it, please hear me. I will give you money for the field; take it from me and I will bury my dead there."** And Ephron answered Abraham, saying to him, **"My lord, listen to me; the land is worth four hundred shekels of silver. What is that between you and me? So bury your dead" . . . and Abraham weighed out the silver for Ephron which he had named in the hearing of the sons of Heth, four hundred shekels of silver, currency of the merchants. So the field of Ephron which was in Machpelah, which was before Mamre, the field and the cave which was in it, and all the trees that were in the field, which were within all the surrounding borders, were deeded to Abraham**. It is important to know that someone lending you their possession to use for free is still not ownership. While that is a form of favour, the real favour is the one that brings you into ownership.

This is also seen in 2 Samuel 24 when David wanted to make a sacrifice to God on the land of Araunah who volunteered to give it to him for use. David insisted on buying it. In 2 Samuel 24:24, ***then the king said to Araunah, "No, but I will surely buy it from you for a price; nor will I offer burnt offerings to the Lord my God with that which costs me nothing." So David bought the threshing floor and the oxen for fifty shekels of silver.***
2 Samuel 24:25 ***And David built there an altar to the Lord, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings. So the Lord heeded the prayers for the land, and the plague was withdrawn from Israel.*** It was on this land bought by David that Solomon later build the Lord's Temple years later

and a generational stream of blessing was sealed for his lineage. This is shown in 2 Chron. 3:1-2, ***Now Solomon began to build the house of the Lord at Jerusalem on Mount Moriah, where the Lord had appeared to his father David, at the place that David had prepared on the threshing floor of Ornan (variant of Araunah) the Jebusite. And he began to build on the second day of the second month in the fourth year of his reign.***

Imagine the spiritual blessing that comes from being the owner of the land where God's House is built and nations come to worship God. All that blessing would have gone to Araunah's lineage if David took the land for free use and did not purchase it for ownership. I have seen people buy lands and telecommunication multinationals later come to lease it for a mast paying periodic huge dividends. If that land was borrowed or leased, that blessing would go to the owner not to the user. Ownership of land is setting up your children for a huge blessing.

Ownership is dominion; we have dominion over what we own. But what we must not allow what we own, to have dominion over us. In other words, you are to own things and they are not to own you. God is actually the only real owner and we are stewards of whatever He allows us to own - this is stewardship in ownership. We must pursue ownership with the mindset of stewardship. The acid test of stewardship is that whatever you own, you are willing and able to lay down when God demands for it. The consciousness a believer in ownership should live with is that "I am actually not the real owner of all I own; I'm just being privileged to be a steward managing God's resources in my hands." For believers with such heart, there is no limit to what God can commit into their hands. Thus, the wisdom of ownership is not merely an obsession to accumulate possessions, but a desire for advancement of God's kingdom through our control of earthly resources for Him.

Like Abraham in Gen 22: 1- 18, who laid down Isaac, there is nothing God commits into our hands that we should not be able to lay down. The wisdom of ownership must be accompanied with the wisdom of stewardship.

CHAPTER 9

THE WISDOM OF INDEPENDENCE

All humans were born dependent - starting from the period of gestation when the human fetus was entirely dependent on their mother for food, water, air and every other thing needed for life, to when the baby is born and it becomes utterly dependent on people around. This is a deliberate design from God to humble everyone so that there is no one that can lay claim to utter independence throughout their lifetime. The very place of utter independence on any other is reserved by Elohim for Himself. 'Elohim' means 'The Self-Existent, Self-Sustaining, Eternal One'.

Thus, it is okay to be dependent on others at certain points in life. As a matter of fact, throughout our lifetime, we will always have reasons to be dependent on others for one thing or the other. Therefore, 'The Wisdom of Dependence' is something every one that will succeed in life must have. We must know when we need others and must be humble enough to receive their help and input. Additionally, we must never outgrow dependence on God. The reason numerous people are going to hell is because they refuse to depend on Jesus Christ for salvation and try to earn it by their own merit. Therefore,It is okay to depend on others when we need to.

While dependence, especially for daily life survival and sustenance, seems to come to humans by default, independence has to be learned.

As it relates to taking responsibility for one's own life outcomes, dependence seems okay at certain stages, but at some point it begins to look ugly.

Moses prayed for Judah, ***"Hear, Lord, the voice of Judah, and bring him to his people; let his hands be sufficient for him, and may You be a help against his enemies.***" (Deut. 33:7). The prayer for one's hand to be sufficient for him/her is very important. It means that one has means to meet personal needs and rise up to one's life responsibilities without dependence on another for survival or sustenance. It is wisdom to lean dependently on God and God-given people at some points in life but it is necessary wisdom to pursue independence in life.

In basic examples, a person who cannot afford a home of his own and is putting up with someone is not yet independent; a person who needs other people or even the government to support before they can feed is not independent. It is important to take up responsibility and pursue independence and freedom because our highest potential, most times, manifests when we learn to stand without human crutches.

Independence is a requirement for good leadership. Leadership involves learning to be independent of the followers' resources as far as meeting your needs is concerned. In other words, a leader must develop faith and capacity to have his/her needs met without dependence on the follower. A leader that is a burden on the followers is not a true leader. The very spirit of leadership is the flow of honour from the led to the leader. Dependence on the part of the leader destroys the fabric of that honour.
This is the reason Paul said, '***make it your ambition to lead a quiet life: You should mind your own business and work with your hands, just as we told you. so that your daily life may win the respect of outsiders and so***

that you will not be dependent on anybody.' (1 Thess. 4:11 -12 NIV) He added in 2 Thess. 3:6, ***'Our orders—backed up by the Master, Jesus—are to refuse to have anything to do with those among you who are lazy and refuse to work the way we taught you. Don't permit them to freeload on the rest. We showed you how to pull your weight when we were with you, so get on with it. We didn't sit around on our hands expecting others to take care of us. In fact, we worked our fingers to the bone, up half the night moonlighting so you wouldn't be burdened with taking care of us. And it wasn't because we didn't have a right to your support; we did. We simply wanted to provide an example of diligence, hoping it would prove contagious*** (The Message).

There are many forms of dependence but they start mostly with financial or emotional dependence. Financial dependence is when you do not have the means of resources to meet your own needs and always have to fall back on someone else. This robs people of the freedom of self-determination and decision. The highest gift God gave man is self-will and lack of independence robs one of this. Thus, pursuing financial independence will go a long way in positioning you to fulfil your destiny. Financial independence is the state of having systems in place that generate income whether you are actively involved or not, so that your time is free to do other things for the rest of your life. It comes as a result of having consistent residual and passive income that is above your total expenditure, whose cash flow continues for the rest of your life whether you continue to work or not. It is also in the spirit of independence that one must seek not to be totally dependent on a job or boss for a lifetime.

Emotional dependence is the inability to survive and thrive without the involvement of a particular person, system or thing in your life.

It is a needy and uncontrollable state of attachment to a person or thing for your sense of wholeness. Emotional and spiritual dependence is more sinister than financial dependence many times. It is one reason people stay in abusive relationships, it is at the base of wrong associations and substance addictions. The only person we are called to be totally emotionally and spiritually dependent on is God, not a parent, friend, spouse, a man/woman of God or even a spouse.
Even in spousal relationships, emotional and spiritual dependence is God's will. God has not called you to be emotionally or spiritually dependent on your partner, that space is His alone in your life.

What God wants is interdependence. Interdependence is the state of being emotionally, spiritually and financially stable, but willingly surrendering one's independence to be dependent on another in some areas while the other person is equally dependent on one in some areas too. This births interdependence for mutual support of each other.

Independence is not the goal of life; interdependence is. However, a dependent person cannot get into a phase of interdependence with others. There is a level of independence and stability that is requisite before one can be in a relationship where you receive and provide reciprocal value.
All healthy and balanced relationships are based on interdependence. Interdependence is hinged on development of self- value first. So every man started dependent; we were dependent on parents, relatives and people around. He/she must then deliberately pursue independence and when he gets it, he realises that he needs people but he also has value in himself to realise that they need him as well. Ultimately, he lays down this independence willingly to give, receive and live interdependently on others. Thus, there is also the wisdom of interdependence.

CHAPTER 10

THE WISDOM OF GROWTH

Growth is one of the most powerful mysteries of life. One of the wisest decisions one can make is to be committed to continual growth in every area of life. There are untold potentials and opportunities available to anyone who keeps growing. The egg in the womb of a woman is fertilised and with growth, it becomes a sophisticated human being who manufactures jet engines, designs complex computer systems and sits as executive over a board of conglomerates, multinationals and national organisations. Growth is the difference between little and great. Thus, **Matt 13: 31 explains that the Kingdom of Heaven is like a mustard seed which a man took and sowed in his field, which is indeed the least of all the seeds; but when it is grown it is greater than the herbs and becomes a tree, so that the birds of the air come and nest in its branches. (NKJV).**

The Kingdom way is starting small and growing big. Growth is being ever-progressive: it must be seen as a journey and not a destination. Don't ever stop growing. When people think they have arrived and do not strive for growth , they begin to lose worth and relevance. Growth makes you magnetic and keeps you relevant. One way to keep growing is to keep learning and keep daring new things that stand the chance of moving you forward.

However, it is important to note that one's environment determines and

affects the chances of growth. Fishes grow in water and die on land. A lion reigns supreme in the jungle and dies in water. An eagle dominates in the sky but struggles in a cage. You do not stand an equal chance of thriving in all environments.

Your environment which describes the culture, practices, location, facilities, resources, organisation and people around you, determines your growth. It is wise to change environment if where you are is not supportive of growth.

Mark 4: 31 - 33 says, ***"The kingdom of God is as if a man should scatter seed on the ground, and should sleep by night and rise by day, and the seed should sprout and grow, he himself does not know how. For the earth yields crops by itself: first the blade, then the head, after that the full grain in the head. But when the grain ripens, immediately he puts in the sickle, because the harvest has come."*** The sower sows the seed and with the right systems in place, it grows till it produces massive fruits. The earth, by a divine ordinance, is commanded to make things grow whenever the right systems are in place.

Another important growth system is your routines. Routines are things you do consistently and periodically that sharpen the outcome of your life. There are routines that produce growth and routines that prevents growth. When you see a child daily, you do not notice he/she is growing. However, after a while, growth is noticeable on sight. Routines are very powerful system for growth A beginner in learning a skill becomes a master by the routine of daily rehearsal, practice and workouts. Growth produced by routines may be unnoticeable at first as daily routines seem not to be making much difference until one day when remarkable growth becomes obvious. Daily routines of growth include daily extensive time of prayer, solitary

meditation, study, reading and writing, rehearsal and practice, exercise and workouts, diligent repeated exertion at a task, learning and training, productivity, value addition and selling.

Therefore, the wisdom of growth entails knowing what to order aright in your life, environment, attitudes, routines and systems that growth becomes a spontaneous effect of your daily life. Success comes on its own as the system for growth is put in place.

Growth must be holistic; growing in an aspect of life and leaving out another produces a handicapped Growth must be intentional and strategic for it to be beneficial. The first step in growing sustainably is to understand what holistic growth entails because it is very possible to grow in an area of life and not grow in another. A vital understanding in growth is to know the vital areas of life-growth. Growing in an area of life and not growing in another produces an haphazard life-structure that eventually results in life-malfunction and sometimes, life-collapse.

The multi-dimensional nature of growth is described in the developments of Samuel who was said to 'grow in stature, in favour with the Lord and in favour with men' and, Jesus who 'grew, and waxed strong in spirit, was filled with wisdom and the grace of God was upon him .'
The different dimensions to growth include;
(i) Spiritual Growth in one's relationship with God.
(ii) Mental Growth in knowledge, understanding and intellectual development.
(iii) Emotional Growth in self-mastery, character and conduct.
(iv) Financial Growth in developing additional streams of income

and expanding existing ones.
(v) Growth in skills, proficiency, certifications, training, and expertise – becoming more proficient in existing skills and/or developing new ones.
(vi) Relational and Social Growth; in strengthening beneficial relationships, making new advantageous connections and truncating exiting toxic relationships.
(vii) Material and Structural Growth in acquisition of more possession, generation of greater results, organizational expansion and numerical addition to what one does.
(viii) Physical, Biological and Chronological Growth which comes as a result of chronological passage of time.

Please note that; physical/biological growth is the only dimension of growth that is automatic. Even at that, the right environment like good food, shelter and air have to be in place. Every other dimension of growth needs to be intentionally engaged. The only thing that grows in many people's lives is their chronological age. Such people are not growing up, they are merely growing old.

Exercise

Write out three areas of your life where you have noticed growth over the last five years.

1.
2.
3.

Write out three areas of your life where you have not noticed commendable growth over the last 3 years

1.
2.
3.

Write 5 changes you will make to your environment, attitude or relationship to trigger growth in areas of arrested growth

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.

Write out 5 routines you will automate daily or periodically for growth in all vital areas of your life.

CHAPTER 11

THE WISDOM OF CHANGE

Change is often desired and often feared. This is because change is accompanied by risk, inconvenience and sometimes, pain. Many people are very reluctant to change, and only do so when the pain of remaining the same exceeds the pain of change. It takes the bold, the self-driven, the ambitious and the confident one to initiate personal and corporate change. Wisdom many times reveals itself in the ability to know what, when, how and where to effect change. This is the reason it is often said that **'the ability to change is a measure of intelligence'.**

One great mistake people often make is wishing for change without changing anything. The truth is that nothing changes until things are changed. Some people even harbour the thought that a change of year (that wonderful 'happy new year' feeling) will automatically lead to a change of life. Nothing can be further from the truth. Wisdom is knowing what to change in order to change your situation.

Numbers 23: 19 says, ***God is not a man, so he does not lie. He is not human, so he does not change his mind . . . .*** Active proponents of this scripture have rightfully emphasised the point that it is unlike God to change. Many have missed the salient point that this scripture hereby acknowledges, that it is absolutely normal for man to change. In fact, never changing would be abnormal for a man, because then, he would be laying claim to being God. I guess you are not GOD, therefore, you need to be open to change.

God says, ***I am the Lord, and I do not change . . .*** A quality of God is that He does not change. The flip side of this statement is that the quality of man is change. The reason God does not change is not because He detests change, but because He does not need to. God has factored all things from eternity past, present and future into view before He acts, speaks or decides, so, He will never need to change who He is, what He did or what He said.

Without change, there is no difference between yesterday and today. Without change, there won't be a difference between today and tomorrow. The most important factor in life, growth and success is not the passage of time, but the effecting of positive change. Every progress in life will be as a result of making intentional decisions towards positive change.

This does not mean we should change everything and at every time But as said, 'the main dangers in this life are the people who want to change everything—or nothing. Thus, the most dangerous and most endangered people are those who want to change everything and those who want nothing to change.

Exercise:
Write out the areas of your life that need improvement and the specific changes you will effect in those areas:

Create a Spread sheet with the following areas of your life

Area of Life	**What are the things I need to change?**	**What are the specific changes I must affect?**
Spiritual Life/ Relationship with God		
Finances/Money Management		
Career/Work/Business		
Purpose/Vision/ Ministry		

CHAPTER 12

THE WISDOM OF WORK

The first revelation of God in scripture is that He is a God that works. The very first verse in scripture defines God as Creator. Creation of anything is a tasking work, both mentally and physically. In fact, Gen 2:2 says by the seventh day God had finished the work he had been doing; ***so on the seventh day he rested from all his work.*** God is working, therefore, man created in His image and likeness must be working.

Man was created to work. The Bible says **"*Now the Lord God had planted a garden in the east, in Eden; and there he put the man he had formed. The Lord God made all kinds of trees grow out of the ground - trees that were pleasing to the eyes and good for food…..the Lord God took the man and put him in the Garden of Eden to work it and take care of it. Ans the Lord commanded the man, You are free to eat from any tree in the garden; but you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, for when you eat from it, you will certainly die."*** (Gen2: 8, 9,15-17). The first thing God gave man after He created Him was work. It is amazing that God created all that man needed for food in the garden, but still gave him work nonetheless. This shows that the purpose of work is not to have food to eat but to fulfil the divine mandate of productivity. Earning money, food, clothing and shelter are side benefits of work. Work in itself has intrinsic value, benefits and worth. The average person, if freely given all that is needed for survival may see no reason to exert himself in productive labour. A wise person, when given all needed for sustenance,

sees that as an opportunity to work at their life vision and assignment and not for survival.

Wise people are industrious and productive. Diligent work is the nature of God and it is the culture of kingdom citizen. Diligence at work is wisdom and laziness is foolishness. Whether the work is your personal vision or you are employed in another person's vision, how dilligent you are at work is a measure of your character. In John 5:17, Jesus says, " ***My Father never stops working, so why should I?*** " This shows that God the Father is always working and Jesus the Son is working. 1 Corinthians 12:11 also says, ***But one and the same Spirit works all these things . . . .*** " Thus, the Holy Spirit is also working. Now, if the Father, Son and the Holy Spirit are working. Then how do you explain a believer who is not working. There must be something you can do, you had better get to diligent work!

While work was not originally created by God for earning a living but for fulfilling life purpose, working to earn in today's world is legitimate wisdom. So, getting a job so that you can earn a living is the starting point of progress for a person financially stranded. Contrary to the popular motivational speakers' cliches, 'don't work for money, let money work for you!' Working for money is prestigious and honourable. Especially when it is accompanied with the financial intelligence to make the money earned later work for you and build wealth. Employment work (a job) is most of the time, a good starting place for those who have no personal or inherited fortune to start with before they proceed to intrapreneurial work and subsequently to entrepreneurial work. Wealth and riches is linked to work. Do not be ashamed of working no matter how menial or unprestigious the job seems. Start from there, but have a resolute vision to build something

greater for yourself. Living without working is wasting life.

There are different levels of work. There is physical work, mental/intellectual work and spiritual work. Physical exertion is necessary for productivity. Sedentariness due to laziness causes diseases, failure and poverty. Prov. 6: 6 instructs "***take a lesson from the ants, you lazybones. Learn from their ways and become wise! Though they have no prince or governor or ruler to make them work, they labor hard all summer, gathering food for the winter. But you, lazybones, how long will you sleep? When will you wake up? A little extra sleep, a little more slumber, a little folding of the hands to rest— then poverty will pounce on you like a bandit; scarcity will attack you like an armed robber"***. Intellectual work is tasking your mind to create solutions. As great as physical diligence is, intellectual diligence is even more rewarding. Those who task their minds will employ those who only task their bodies. Reading, intellectual development, learning skills, taking courses, thinking and writing are all work. I often ask students, 'how is work?' and some reply, 'I am not working, I am a student?' I did not know students only play. Until you approach schooling as work, you can't make something great of your academics. Also, in addition to academics, work to earn, make money and develop yourself as a student.

The third level of work is spiritual work. Spiritual work controls and determines the outcome of all other levels of work. When one labours physically and intellectually but is lazy spiritually, such a person is exposed to the risk of fruitless labour. Make sure all your physical and mental exertions are backed up with adequate spiritual efforts, else one stands the chance of being a victim despite doing all things right in the natural. Spiritual work includes prayers, fasting, giving and sacrifices, studying, meditation and confessing God's word. In John 6:28-29, some

people asked Jesus, ***"What must we do to do the works God requires?" and Jesus answered, "The work of God is this: to believe in the one he has sent."*** So, even believing is work. Faith is spiritual work. Do not allow anyone to make you think you are wasting time or lazying away praying, believing and putting spiritual efforts. However, spiritual work without physical and mental work will never produce results. Conversely, physical and mental work without spiritual work is a recipe for a life of struggles.

Exercise

Itemise all the things that you want to engage yourself with that will enhance your productivity in life.

1.

2.

3.

More….

CHAPTER 13

THE WISDOM OF IMPACT

One of the wisest decisions in life is the decision to live for impact. There is a difference between accomplishment and impact. Accomplishments are the additions you make for yourself. Impact is the addition you make to others. An accomplished person may not be impactful, but it is possible to be both accomplished and impactful. If you ever have to choose between being accomplished and being impactful, choose both!

Positive impact is one's strength to cause positive effect or change in the lives of others. Impact is one's ability to modify people's situation, lifestyle and experience through concentrated actions, relationships and conversations with them. The end-point of impact is to inspire change from the present to a more desirable future for people. It involves giving your time, resources, ability, money and sometimes, your entire self and life so that others can have a better life.

Genuine impact stems from selfless service rendered for the betterment of others. It is absolutely correct to measure people’s greatness by the weight of their positive impact on others and not merely the abundance of their possessions and accomplishments. God’s purpose for your life is impact. Your life purpose is to glorify God and impact humanity through fulfilling your God-given assignment. So, you are created by God to impact your generation in your identified sphere(s) of influence through your life assignment.

Jesus declares in John 12:8 ***"I am the light of the world: he that follows me shall not walk in darkness, but shall have the light of life."*** Jesus walked the earth to bring light to those who lived in darkness. He came to the world to release man held in bondage and to give light to the darkened soul of man - that is impact! He said **"As long as I am in the world, I am the light of the world."** (John 9: 5). This means that His baton of Kingdom impact is automatically transferred to all His followers whenever He leaves the earth. Thus, as Christians, we are mandated for a life of impact by our Lord, **Matt 5: 14 - 16, "You are the light of the world—like a city on a hilltop that cannot be hidden. No one lights a lamp and then puts it under a basket. Instead, a lamp is placed on a stand, where it gives light to everyone in the house. 16 In the same way, let your good deeds shine out for all to see, so that everyone will praise your heavenly Father.** One is living when people's lives and wellbeing are being enhanced because one is alive. Otherwise, one is just existing.

The primal impact every believer is to make is to impact the people of the world with the "Light of the Gospel of Christ". **Proverbs 11:30 says "The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life; and he that winneth souls is wise."** We have been made righteous in Christ and we are only meant to produce fruits of life in those around us. The greatest of this life-giving fruit is soul winning. Whilst it is vital to be helpful to humanity and be benevolent to people generally, the greatest impact a Christian can make is to win souls, advance the Kingdom and transform people and society to the likeness of God's Kingdom. Evangelism should be the default mode of the child of God. Therefore, preach to people in your social circles and also go on targeted evangelistic outreaches personally or with a group. This is great wisdom because when you get to heaven, you will realise it was the best

investment you made with your time, energy and resources. **Daniel 12:3 says,** ***And they that be wise shall shine as the brightness of the firmament; and they that turn many to righteousness as the stars for ever and ever.***

In addition to evangelism, the following are wisdom keys for impact:
1. Have a platform where you are raising and building up people and making them better. This is not limited to spiritual platforms but also includes secular platforms where you add value to people and make them better. The platform may be founded by you or by someone else while you join to make an impact.

2. Let your finances make an impact on people and for God. Be a financial partner with ministries that are doing the work of God. As you increase financially, make sure that parts of your resources go into helping people and reaching the vulnerable.

3. Have or select people you are mentoring personally to succeed and be your legacy.
Make sure Jesus is glorified through your accomplishments and successes. Let your social media handles be instruments to reach out to people and tell them about Jesus. This is the greatest value you can give to others. And you can start right now, with that person on your mind.

Exercises

1. Write down the name(s) of people you have in mind that you want to impact their lives with the value that you have.
2. Identify a platform that you want to create or join to impact people's life.

CHAPTER 14

THE WISDOM OF SEED

At creation, God programmed the earth to run by the principle of the seed. This means that everything that will happen on earth will start as a seed and grow to maturity. Thus, whatever will happen in a person's life or generally on the earth will happen because the seed for it was sown and nurtured till fruition.

A seed is anything that carries the ability to produce after its kind. A seed is a substance, action, circumstance or thing that carries the potential to produce a predetermined bigger reality with time. In Genesis 1:11 Then God said, ***"Let the land burst forth with every sort of grass and seed-bearing plant. And let there be trees that grow seed-bearing fruit. The seeds will then produce the kinds of plants and trees from which they came. The land was filled seed-bearing plants and trees, and their seeds produced plants and trees of like kind. And God saw that it was good***. Every biological life carries in itself a seed which is the power for continuity and reproduction. Similarly, everything in life has a seed which brought it into being.

The wisdom of seed is one of the most powerful keys in life. It is the guiding principle for knowing what to do to produce a desired result. The wisdom of the seed is that for whatever you want to see in life, there is something to do to trigger it. This wisdom also advises us on what not to do if we do not want to reap certain kinds of harvest.

Matt 7:12 says, ***therefore all things whatsoever ye would that men should do to you, do ye even so to them: for this is the law and the prophets***. The entire Bible is premised on the Principle of the Seed.

It is quite important to know that all seeds do not produce the same harvest. There is a seed for every outcome. In other words, the seed to plant for a good marriage may not be the same to plant for a successful academics or career, The seed for financial prosperity may also be different from the seed of spiritual prosperity. Wisdom is knowing the right seed for your desired result in each area of your life and taking the diligence and sacrifice to plant and nurture that seed.

The truth is that everything in life is a seed - there is a harvest for every word, action and omission. This is the reason you must be deliberate about your seeds. The foremost seed that the Bible reveals is the Word of God. Luke 8:11 says ***now the parable is this: the seed is the word of God. The Word of God is a seed for life and eternity. If you want to live to the fullness and have a blessed eternity, the seed is receiving, believing and doing the Word of God***. Deut.8: 3 says, '. . . ***Man shall not live by bread along but by every word that proceeds from the mouth of the Lord***'. This shows us that the authentic seed for life and living is not food but the Word of God. In addition to the Word of God, your own words are also seeds for the course of your life and the outcome of your destiny. Thus, whatever you say will produce a fruit into your life. Therefore, say only what you want to see and do not say what you do not want to see in your life, even when it is seemingly the obvious reality.

Every of your actions are seeds that you sow for a harvest of people's actions towards you. Whatever one does, whether good or bad, will be received in a harvest.

Luke 6:38 says, ***'Give, and it shall be given unto you; good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over, shall men give into your bosom. For with the same measure that ye mete withal it shall be measured to you again'.*** This scripture is well-known to many believers, but few have read it contextually to realise that Jesus was talking about giving and receiving actions. Money is a seed but actions are more powerful seeds. Helping others freely without vested interest is a seed for having helpers. Showing mercy and favour to people is a seed for receiving the same. Service in other people's vision is a seed for a vision carrier rallying around you to make your vision succeed when you start out on your own.

One of the seeds for a good spouse is how well you treat, build and invest in people of the opposite gender without necessarily wanting anything from them. As an unmarried man/woman, when you have a culture to genuinely help, build and invest in the ladies/young men around you with sincerity of heart without ulterior motives, you are sowing a seed for a good wife/husband. The truth is that the person you are investing in may not be your wife/husband, but when you do it with a seed mentality, God makes sure that someone somewhere is also building the person that you will marry. It is lack of this understanding that makes men think because they helped or invested in a lady, they must demand relationship or sex. If you sow the seed of demanding sex or other forms of gratification from the opposite person you help, there is a harvest for that as well. If you are unmarried, remember the person you will eventually marry is in some people's hands too right now or if you are already married, your daughter will pass through some people's hands too. This law applies to ladies that take advantage of a man sexually or otherwise too. The law of the seed is a universal and eternal law programmed by God.

The power of the seed is that it is often times self-instructing and self-determining. In other words, when you put an agricultural seed in the ground, you do not need to instruct it or supervise it to germinate and grow. As long as the environment is conducive, the seed by itself knows what to do and what to produce. This means that whatever you say or do, it is self-instructive in producing you a harvest. In essence, your actions and words will produce the commensurate harvest even if you beg or try to make it not to. The only way to change a harvest is to change the seed. St. Mark 4:26 says, Jesus also said, "***Here is another illustration of what the Kingdom of God is like: A farmer planted seeds in a field, and then he went on with his other activities. As the days went by, the seeds sprouted and grew without the farmer's help, because the earth produces crops on its own. First a leaf blade pushes through, then the heads of wheat are formed, and finally the grain ripens. And as soon as the grain is ready, the farmer comes and harvests it with a sickle.***" This scripture says that the earth by itself knows what crop to produce when it identifies the seed sown into it and even without the sower's active monitoring, the harvest is nonetheless released to him/her.

Solving problems for people, offering valuable products and services to meet needs and giving money to help people is the seed for financial prosperity. 2 Cor 9:10-11 expresses this very well; ***now he who supplies seed to the sower and bread for food will also supply and increase your store of seed and will enlarge the harvest of your righteousness. You will be made rich in every way so that you can be generous on every occasion, and through us your generosity will result in thanksgiving to God*** (NIV). This scripture points out that God blesses you so as to increase your store of seeds and thereby enlarge your harvest capacity. In other words, when you are faithful in giving to people, tithing, sowing seeds to Kingdom work, God blesses you so that you will have more seed to sow. He makes you richer thereby enabling you to be more generous.

But this I say, He which soweth sparingly shall reap also sparingly; and he which soweth bountifully shall reap also bountifully (2 Cor 9:6). To have a greater harvest, you have to increase the seed sown in that direction.

Looking at the entire salvation story, we will see that Jesus is the seed for salvation and eternal life. Isa. 53: 10 says, ***Yet it pleased the Lord to bruise him; he hath put him to grief: when thou shalt make his soul an offering for sin, he shall see his SEED, he shall prolong his days, and the pleasure of the Lord shall prosper in his hand***. Isa 53:10. The Wisdom of the Seed is so powerful that Jesus came as a Seed. In Heb. 2:16, He was referred to as the Seed of Abraham, Gen 3: 15 prophetically described Him as the Seed of the Woman and He also described Himself as a Seed (John 12: 23 - 24). Therefore, among many revelations of Jesus Christ, is that He is the Seed. He is the Son that God 'seeded' so he can reap a harvest of sons and daughters. It is important to receive the seed of God so that you can be part of His harvest.

Jesus is not just 'The Seed', He also sowed some seeds for the benefit of our harvest. His death was a seed so that we can reap eternal life (Rom 6: 23). His sufferings and stripes were seeds for us to reap health and vitality (Isa. 53: 5). He experienced lack and poverty as seed for you to reap prosperity (2 Cor. 8: 9). He laboured and He wants you to enter into His rest. The areas where Jesus has sown seeds for you in His finished work are inexhaustible. They are waiting for you to discover and harvest them.

CHAPTER 15

THE WISDOM OF WEALTH

One of the best decisions you can ever make in your lifetime is the decision to be rich, backed up with corresponding actions. Poverty is one of the greatest limitations in life. Poverty makes a wise person look foolish and riches have the ability to make a foolish person be accepted as wise. Is it possible to be wise and poor? Absolutely! We have established that there are many streams of wisdom and that it is not all of them that is financial in its expression. When someone has all other streams of wisdom in place but lacks financial wisdom to generate financial results, even all the other streams of wisdom he has is despised by people. The Bible gives the account of a city that was under siege by an enemy-army and ***a poor, wise man knew how to save the town, and so it was rescued. But afterward no one thought to thank him. So even though wisdom is better than strength, those who are wise will be despised if they are poor. What they say will not be appreciated for long (Eccl 9:15-16)***

A wise man who is poor may eventually suffer the same fate with a fool. This is the reason it is wisdom to insist on your wisdom translating to financial wealth. Do all righteously possible and rise up to pay the necessary prices to make sure your knowledge, wisdom, education, gifts, capacity and spirituality translate to wealth in a godly way.

Wealth is not age, race, gender or religion sensitive. It answers to the person who follows the laws of wealth.

You are not too young to be rich neither are you too old. The pursuit of wealth is not a male task and the environment or country of your residence is not a deterrent. Learn the spiritual and physical laws that you need to apply and build wealth. Some of these spiritual laws include giving, positive mental orientation towards wealth, meditation on wealth scriptures, partnering with God, His house and His grace through His vessels. Physical laws include skill and value creation, productivity and diligence, sales and transaction, investment and entrepreneurship and many other laws.

While it is important to emphasize that wealth and prosperity is not limited to finances and money. The foremost wealth is a vital relationship with God and salvation of one's soul and security of one's eternity. Additionally, health is wealth, a good home and happy relationship, and sound mind and an impactful life are all dimensions of wealth. However, this wisdom key is specifically addressing the fact that it is wisdom to be financial wealthy and it is foolishness to be poor.

Poverty is Satan's strategy to make sure that people are survivalist in their approach to life, sub-human in their thinking and do not think about the higher things of life such as fulfilment, impact, purpose and life assignment. A poor person is obsessed with how to get the basic needs of life and is not thinking about impact, fulfilment and self-actualisation. Thus, Prov. 10:15 ***says the rich man's wealth is his strong city: the destruction of the poor is their poverty.***

Wealth is a tool for relevance, influence and impact. These are resources that God wants us to have. Prov 19: 6 says ***Everyone tries to gain the favor of important people; everyone claims the friendship of those who give out favors.***

Even the relatives of a poor person have no use for him; no wonder he has no friends. No matter how hard he tries, he cannot win any. Do yourself a favor and learn all you can; then remember what you learn and you will prosper. (GNT)

You should know that your desire and drive to be rich and wealthy is good and commendable. If you love God and are following Him with all your heart, do not let anyone make you feel you are doing anything wrong in your quest for finances. The world tries to make believers feel bad that they are trying to be rich and paint ministers of God black for being wealthy but celebrate their own people for being rich. Who on earth sold the idea to this world and the social media that they have the monopoly of the right to be rich while God's people are supposed to be poor? This in itself is the trick of Satan to keep the people of God weak, ineffective and without influence. The sad thing is that many Christian have bought into this deception of the devil and they attack other believers, pastors and God's ministers for being rich.

It is important that we do not just wish to become rich; it must be a top priority. Kindly be unapologetic in your drive for financial wealth, do not feel sorry about selling and making money and do not buy into Satan's lie and the world's trick on Christians that 'are you not supposed to do it free for people out of God's love?' that puts pressure on believers to share salvation and the gospel is free but even the means of publishing it are paid for. The believer and the church pay for everything they use just as the world pays for them, So it is unfair to feel that the believer and the church has no right to be paid for offering value. No one complains about the fees of prestigious universities in the world but if any of them is a Christian university, they start complaining that the fees should be free as if the lecturers and staff in the Christian universities are working for free.

Please do not let the opinion of people keep you in courtship with poverty. God wants you to become rich.

Riches and wealth starts with a decision, then an action. The journey to financial stability and overflow begins by aiming for it, working for it and pressing for it. The balance is that you can never do anything wrong to get money. You have to learn God's way to wealth. This includes diligence, productivity, righteousness, faith and engaging the covenant for God's blessing. Any 'wisdom' that is making a believer cheat, lie or manipulate people or organisations to make money is 'foolishness'. A believer should gun for prosperity God's way. The end does not justify the means when it comes to a believer getting money and becoming rich. The means is as important as the end. Any prosperity message that breeds, greed, impatience and crookedness among believers is not of God.

Exercises

1 . Have you made the decision to be rich?

2 . Write out all the business idea that you have in mind and choose the one you want to deal in if you have not started

3 . Write out the book and messages that you will read and listen to, to gather more financial education for yourself.

CHAPTER 16

THE WISDOM OF GIVING

The Law of Giving seems to be a universally accepted law. Nearly all religions, beliefs, schools of thoughts and philosophies believe in the noble idea of giving. Thus, Christians and people of other religions, atheists, humanists, business executives and even sometimes criminals somehow somewhere believe giving is one of the displays of humanity at his best. Perhaps, one of the most popular scriptures in Christianity is John 3:16, ***For God loved the world so much that he gave his one and only Son, so that everyone who believes in him will not perish but have eternal life.*** Giving is the heart of Christianity and the heart of God.

However, beyond the nobility of being a giver, only few understand the blessedness of giving. In the words of Jesus Christ**,** 'It is more blessed to give than to receive.' Acts 20:35
It is wisdom to live a life of giving. You must make sure you are always on the giving side of life and not merely on the receiving side. Givers are the ones that win. One makes money and become rich by giving, giving value, service and what you have to others in exchange for monetary rewards. After making the money, you should also give money to people and God's work as a blessing to them. A giving lifestyle is evidence that you are God-like.

Giving is a spiritual principle that should be recognized and embraced. A man that gives is blessed by God and even prayed for by people.

A stingy man is cursed and hated by his friends. The law of giving is a universal law and works for everyone regardless of race, religion or gender. The Wisdom of giving is understanding the power of living the giving life and being intentional about giving. Do not just give sympathetically when the need arises or when you feel you have excess, Giving should be an intentional, conscious and habitual act, done from a standpoint of understanding how it works. Giving should be an essential part of your life as breathing is. Make sure there is a percentage of your income that is given to God, to His work and to help people. Start from the little you have and as the blessings of giving make more resources come to you, the amount you give also increases.

Giving is like sowing a seed to receive its harvest, so, it is he that sows that reaps the harvest of what he has sown. Prov. 11:24 explains, "***There are those who [generously] scatter abroad, and yet increase more; there are those who withhold more than is fitting or what is justly due, but it results only in want.***" (AMP) A giver is like a sower who scatters his seed on good soil, and then watches the seeds grow into a forest of fruitful vines. A non-giver is like one hold onto his seeds and eats them up. When harvest time comes, there is nothing to eat again. Shying away from giving hence, leads to poverty and lack.

Prov. 11:25 further explains that "***The liberal person shall be enriched, and he who waters shall himself be watered.***" Giving is the wisdom behind enrichment.

The Kingdom's way to prosperity is generosity with an understanding of being an extension of God to bless others. It is also pertinent to know that God is not just interested in the hands that give, but also in the heart that gives. According to 2Cor. 9:7 (AMP), "***Let each one [give] as***

he has made up his own mind and purposed in his heart, not reluctantly or sorrowfully or under compulsion, for God loves (He takes pleasure in, prizes above other things, and is unwilling to abandon or to do without) a cheerful (joyous, "prompt to do it") giver [whose heart is in his giving]." The heart where the giving comes from should be a heart of joy and cheerfulness. To enjoy the blessings that giving brings, it should not be done under compulsion or coercion. A sower sows his seeds with joyful expectation of imminent harvest, not in worry over having to part with the seeds. Many givers do not get the fullness of the blessings for their giving, because rather than rejoicing over the opportunity to sow seeds, they are forlorn over parting with the seeds. In other words, your attitude matters when you give. The right attitude is joy and cheerfulness when giving. Any opposite attitude will make you lose your harvest.

A last note on the wisdom of giving: extremely prosperous and wealthy people in the Kingdom are those who don't just give when it is convenient, but give even when it is inconvenient like Abraham who was willing to give his precious son Isaac as a sacrifice when demanded by God (Gen.22:2). People who love nothing more than their relationship with God and would willingly give up everything and anything for God are the ones God will entrust with the true riches of His Kingdom. In other words, it does not just matter that you give, how much you give matters. Thus, 2 Cor 9: 6 says ***"But this I say, He which soweth sparingly shall reap also sparingly; and he which soweth bountifully shall reap also bountifully."*** Note that the true value of your giving is not in how much you give, but how much is left after you give.

CHAPTER 17

THE WISDOM OF SKILL

Prov. 4: 7 says, t***he beginning of Wisdom is: get Wisdom (skillful and godly Wisdom)! [For skillful and godly Wisdom is the principal thing.] And with all you have gotten, get understanding (discernment, comprehension, and interpretation)***. (AMP). The Amplified Bible uses the two adjectives 'skillful and godly' to describe Wisdom in the Book of Proverbs. It can be inferred from this that two major manifestation of wisdom are in the area of character (godliness) and enterprise (skill or craft). Mastery of one's craft is wisdom in that craft. Brilliance, expertise, proficiency and skill are synonyms for wisdom at a craft. No matter how great in character and morals a person is, certain levels of influence and success can only be accessed through high skill. Prov. 22:29 says Do you see a man skilled in his work? He will stand in the presence of kings He will not stand in the presence of unknown men. (HCSB)

In Deut. 33:11-12, Moses prayed for the Tribe of Levi, ***'Bless all his skills, O Lord, and be pleased with the work of his hands. Smite the loins of those who rise up against him; strike his foes till they rise no more."*** (NIV). It is important to know that one paramount channel of the flow of God's blessing to you is your skill. It is wisdom to acquire marketable skills and to develop them to a point of finesse that people will be willing to pay you anything to benefit from your skill. Prov. 22: 29 says,, ***'Do you see a man skilled in his work? He will serve before***

kings; he will not serve before obscure men.' (NLT). Skill is a leveler; it is the antidote against racism, discrimination and biases. When you surpass everyone else in skill, you will be sought after. When people who have sentiments against you become your pals in business and are forced to come to you because of your skill, then you have passed the excellence test.

In Exo. 31: 1 - 5, The Lord said to Moses, "See, I have chosen Bezalel son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah, and I have filled him with the Spirit of God, with skill, ability and knowledge in all kinds of crafts — to make artistic designs for work in gold, silver and bronze, to cut and set stones, to work in wood, and to engage in all kinds of craftsmanship. Moreover, I have appointed Oholiab son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan, to help him. Also I have given skill to all the craftsmen to make everything I have commanded you (NIV)

A person can be anointed with the Spirit of Wisdom, manifesting as skills and expertise in a particular field. Thus, believers need to partner with the Holy Spirit so that they become extremely skillful at their crafts, this is the way the world will be shown the supremacy of God. We must make it a point of duty to be at the peak of performance in all our endeavours. Christianity is not a call to secular mediocrity; it is a call to skill. Exchange of skilled value is what translates to financial return in the marketplace. Meaning, a person may be spiritually sound but is struggling financially because there is no transactable skill he/she has.

It is not enough to develop skill, it is vital to generate high income skills. In this age, there are many soft, digital and leadership skills that are financially rewarding.

You may be a skill away from your next level. It is wisdom to be very skillful at what you do, so that you are highly sought after and rewarded handsomely for what you do. It is the Kingdom way to prosperity.

Exercises

1. Research the internet and write out 30 high income skills in contemporary times.

2. Research the 50 richest people in the world and check what they do to make their money

3. Research the 20 best paid/richest people in your field or prospective field and check out the level of expertise of their work.

4. Write out 5 things you can do to increase your skill at what you do.

5. Write out 3 new skills you can learn that will consolidate what you currently do.

CHAPTER 18

THE WISDOM OF LEARNING

‘Learning is synonymous to living’; this statement cannot be over-emphasised. Meaning, ‘to live is to learn; and to stop learning, is to stop living’. Learning is the noble factor that defines one's quality of life. Societally, a learned person has potential for a higher quality of life and is considered and distinguished than his/her unlearned peers. This implies that, one indispensable virtue that makes for greatness in life is learning; the enthusiasm and the guided passion to go for knowledge and acquire it. Learning is the humility to consider one’s self as having little and being open to receive more. It is one's discontentment with the current level of one's exposure, and then seeking to be more enlightened. Learning begins with the acknowledgement of one's insufficiencies and inadequacies, then subjecting oneself to impartation and equipping of knowledge.

The Bible in Prov. 1:5 says: ***"A wise man will hear, and will increase learning; and a man of understanding shall attain unto wise counsels."*** This is to say that a wise man is one who gives his ears to hearing, so as to increase his learning. The scripture here, measures one's wisdom by one's openness to listen and learn. Learning is not a passive experience; it is an intentional act of yielding and receiving. In Acts 7:22, the Bible says: ***"And Moses was learned in all the wisdom of the Egyptians, and was mighty in words and in deeds."*** This scripture here as well, measures one's might by learning.

Moses was a mighty man in his speech and exploits, because he was a man who gave himself to learning. So, the degree of one's might in a discipline is determined by how much one has given himself to intentional learning.

There is a general scope of learning about life and living, which is naturally acquired as one grows up into maturation. And there are also specific disciplines across various spheres of influence that one can be subjected to, for learning unto mastery and professionalism. These domains include; economics, politics, medicine, technology, law, art, industrialization, etc. And the vehicle of learning that drives a person into being a master in these domains is academic education. The misconception about "school being scam" should be outrightly cleared off. A believer should not be clouded by the foolish religiosity of seeing schooling as unnecessary and irrelevant. School is a secular institution that helps to reproduce a naive mind into a mastermind in a specific course. Hence, a wise believer is one who is not just spiritually advancing, but excellently doing well in his field of study or discipline.

Daniel and his friends in (Dan. 1:4) were selected and chosen to be taught in the wisdom of the Chaldeans; a group of ***noble scholars who minister to the King in counsel and understanding. "Children in whom was no blemish, but well favored, and skillful in all wisdom, and cunning in knowledge, and understanding science, and such as had ability in them to stand in the king's palace, and whom they might teach the learning and the tongue of the Chaldeans."*** They were picked because of their excellence in the academia as students when they were in Israel; and having being taught of the culture of a strange country, they excelled in wisdom and understanding than all their peers. ***"And in all matters of wisdom and understanding, that the king enquired of them, he found them ten times***

better than all the magicians and astrologers that were in all his realm." (Dan. 1:20) The spirit of excellence was able to work on their minds because of their diligence to learn and study.

Apostle Paul was writing to his son in the Lord and mentee, Timothy, in (2Tim. 2:15) **"*Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.*"** Learning gives you confidence and keeps your chin up when you stand in any gathering. And in a case of a person who has been schooled into heresy and wrong doctrine; reordering such person unto rightness is still through learning. So, it is of a surety, that as one grows through life, there will always be the need to learn, unlearn and learn; having no shame for corrections. Apostle Paul further exhorts in (2Tim. 3:14) "But continue thou in the things which thou hast learned and hast been assured of, knowing of whom thou hast learned them" This is a call for continuity in learning, but only in a doctrine which has been proven and is true, as backed up by the integrity of the one from who one learns. So, it is not just to learn, but to also assess and discern the uprightness of the teacher, by appraising his track record of steadfastness and rectitude over time.

The wisdom of learning is a pathway to excellence and mastery in any discipline. The brilliant and brainy ones are always the ones who gave themselves to learning in diligence by reading of books, studying materials, taking courses, exploring the web, making researches and connecting with like-minded scholars as themselves. Make a life commitment today to be intentional and passionate about learning, and you would be sure of a life of beauty and glory.

CHAPTER 19

THE WISDOM OF CONSISTENCY

Consistency is one proof of greatness. It takes greatness to execute a commendable project but it takes 'greater greatness' to consistently deliver on it. When you meet someone who has consistently lived up to repeated outstanding demand, expectation, and task or feat for a long span of time, you have met a great person.

Many people do commendable things - win a challenge, organise an event, exert at worthy disciplines, or carry out notable undertakings here and there, but the dilemma of success is whether they will do it again and for how long they will be able to sustain it. The truth is that the magnitude of what we do is, often times, not as important as how many times we do it. Truly, one will go further by consistently taking incremental steps than mustering all one's strength for a jump that leaves one exhausted and gasping for breath. A mistake people always make is trying to take one big step which they cannot sustain instead of consistently taking repeated steps in the same direction over a long period of time.

Organisations grow by building and widening their operation base through incremental addition rather than by daring doing over-sized projects or events that they can't run consistently. Start-up businesses and ministries, show artists, aspiring musicians and public speakers, and some other categories of people who provide value/service through gathering people for events often make the mistake of rating magnitude

over consistency. Some have gone to the extent of pushing themselves beyond limits or even incur my debt to host an event in an attempt to gather an enormous number people. The starter usually spends so much to host an event and invite a 'big name' in his field, whose presence will compel a crowd. However, if such an event cannot be consistently sustained what usually happens is that the big event creates a big sensation and a pseudo picture of growth which returns to status quo immediately the event is over. If the intention is to generate a one-time profit on ticket sale or just make an impression that makes sense, but if it is to sustainably build a platform, consistency is the name of the game.

Of course, this is not to say that big events are not valuable. The truth is that such events are of great use when there is a platform that runs consistently which the event will feed, and into which the proceeds from the big event will be harvested. Everyone who has ever built a working platform - business, ministry or charity, knows that many times, the proceeds of growth from a mega event, no matter how minimal could be worthwhile as long as it adds value to an existing consistent platform one is building. It is wise not to measure success merely by the execution of a mega project but by its addition spiritually, numerically, intellectually or otherwise to the existing platform. Consistency allows growth to be measurable.

James 1:25 says ***but he who looks into the perfect law of liberty AND CONTINUES IN IT, and is not a forgetful hearer but a doer of the work, this one will be blessed in what he does*** (NKJV). Even beneficial spiritual, intellectual and character disciplines only thrive on the basis of consistency. An emergency approach to such disciplines will not give the desired results. There are people who declare unreasonably long days of marathon fasting and prayers because they have problems, not

knowing that they would experience more spiritual impact and growth, and probably have avoided the problem if they had developed a consistent program of hours of regular prayers and fasting, and consistent study over time. It is the same mind-set that makes students crash read when examination has dawned upon them instead of building a consistent reading culture over the term.

1 Timothy 4:16 says, ***Take heed unto thyself, and unto the doctrine; continue in them: for in doing this thou shalt both save thyself, and them that hear thee.*** It is in consistency and continuing to do the right things that you bring profit to yourself and people around you. The blessedness of any good practice is the consistency of doing it. Consistency ascertains progress and results. It is very important to factor consistency in our plans. Sometimes, it is wise not to initiate things until you are sure you can sustain it consistently, Visions die without consistency, even brilliant performances result in failure without consistency. Consistency birth results and makes one outstanding. Whatever beneficial thing you are doing, factor consistency into the plan.

CHAPTER 20

THE WISDOM OF CHARACTER

From historical times, the world has seen the emergence of powerful leaders, with brilliant minds and skillful hands across various spheres of influence. These leaders were notable for their conquests, royalty, inventions, philosophies, business strategies, political policies, creative arts, military power, etc. They held the world in awe, for their indelible impacts on the sands of time; men revered them as gods on earth. But, sadly, in spite of their great achievements and successes, many of them failed to secure their great names in the stronghold of good character, and so, they were not worthy models.

Character is a virtue; the quality of being just and doing justice. Character is one's strength to adhere to principles that make for morality and integrity. The features of good character will define it more explicitly; truthfulness, uprightness, straightforwardness, authenticity, honesty, integrity, rectitude, temperance, humility, courage, faithfulness, sincerity, perseverance, etc. These and many other moral virtues are the indices to measure a person of good character.

The Bible instructs in Philippians 4:8 "Finally, brethren, whatsoever things are true, whatsoever things are honest, whatsoever things are just, whatsoever things are pure, whatsoever things are lovely, whatsoever things are of good report; if there be any virtue, and if there be any praise, think on these things.

The Amplified version says ***"think on and weigh and take account of these things [fix your minds on them]" That is, keep them in your mind, meditate on them, let them become the underlying principles which defines your actions and reactions.***

The need to be a person of strong and upright character can never be overemphasized, the Bible is full of stories of men whose lack of good character cost them their birth rights, thrones, destines, fulfilments, and even their lives. These men struggled to keep up with the quality of being a person of good character, but they could not, and hence, their stories ended tragically. Even the wisest man that ever lived, who himself taught on the essence of good character in Proverbs 1:7a, ***"The fear of the Lord is the beginning of knowledge"*** could not hold on to his convictions till the end. This is what then gave rise to the notion of "no one is perfect, we are all humans, after all". So, men began to justify their wrongs with excuses of just being human, which may appear understandable and consolable, but the reign of corruption continues to extend across dispensations.

It is important to know that the wisest thing to do at any point is the godliest thing. Whenever, you are at a crossroad of choice between good and evil. Know that 'good' is the wise choice even if it looks stupid as at the time. A life of character and moral uprightness is a life of wisdom. Cutting corners, making unprincipled compromises and bending standards even when they present better outcomes temporarily will always cost more in the long run. Integrity, godliness and good character are great wisdom and they are the foundation and sustaining power of all other types of wisdom.

Jesus Christ, the All-Wise One came as the exact portrait of the character which God expects His children to possess.

Jesus came to show us the possibilities of living a life of godliness, even in a perverse world; and then gave us the nature of God, by which we can become people of good character and live a godly lifestyle, pleasing and acceptable to God. The Most Holy One is also the All Wise One - this hits home the point that character is wisdom.

Believers in Christ Jesus are potentially natured to live a life of godliness, which is the benchmark of character. We are without excuses, for we have the nature of God which is godliness. This is possible because of the indwelling of the Spirit of God in us, which when nurtured, produces fruits of godliness. These fruits, doctrinally known as the fruits of the Spirit are clearly outlined in Galatians 5:22-23 **"But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, gentleness, goodness, faith, meekness, temperance: against such there is no law."**
Believers should become models of good character across various sectors and strata. We should be able to say 'No' to fornication and adultery, like Joseph, "how shall I do this and sin against God." We should be able to imitate Daniel and say: " I will not defile myself with the King's sumptuous meal". And like the three Hebrew men, **"Let it be known to you o King, we will not bow to your god".** And also like Apostle Paul, in the midst of affliction and persecution, "to live is Christ and to die is gain." This wisdom of character will not just keep us upright in our dealings with others, but will also secure our glorious destinies in God. The world should come to us to know of this wisdom of character, and by this, we can change the ungodly system of the world unto Christ-Centeredness.

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CHAPTER 21

THE WISDOM OF HUMILITY

Humility is an essential virtue of character and wisdom in a Christian. One ultimate measure of Christlikeness in a person is the level of humility. Matt 11: 28 - 29 says, ***Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take my yoke upon you and learn from me, for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For my yoke is easy and my burden is light.*** Among many things to learn from Jesus Christ is His kind of humility.

Humility is knowing who you are, being secure and confident in yourself at whatever phase of life you are, knowing fully well that God is the one who made you all you are and being confident He is the one who will make you all you still need to be, therefore, ascribing all the glory and honor due to Him for anything you are or have. Pride is undue preoccupation with oneself, opinions, ambitions, abilities, accomplishments, position, or possessions. Many times, it manifests in seeing others as inferior and expecting glory or recognition from others for one's self-perceived worth.

Prov. 16: 7 lists the things God hates and number one is a proud countenance/heart. If sins were in hierarchies, pride would be rated as number one ; after all, it is the oldest sin that gives birth to all other sins. If virtues were also in hierarchies, humility would rate first.

Sadly, humility has been grossly misconceived and misunderstood to mean self-abasement, being cowardly and unconfident, or walking with heads and backs bowed in timidity and subservience. Another misconception in Christianity about being humble is that humility is a noble art of denying your strength and being over-conscious of your weaknesses. Humility is not living a low life with no aspiration for greatness. Jesus, the Most Humble did not mince words about declaring who He was and how great He was. When He told them that He was the Son of God, the Messiah that was to come, the One greater than Abraham, Solomon and all the prophets, they could not handle that level of boldness.

It is wisdom to be humble, however make sure what you call humility is not conferred upon you by the expectation of people but by God's definition as revealed in the life of Jesus.

Apostle Paul instructs in Phil. 2:3 ***"Let nothing be done through strife or vainglory; but in lowliness of mind let each esteem other better than themselves."*** A humble person knows who he is and what he is capable of but still has high regards for one another, appreciating our own strengths, knowing they are given by God and at the same time, recognizing, appreciating and celebrating others for their uniqueness, and we should forbear one another in love and faith. A humble person is quick to transfer praise to others while a proud person has a voracious appetite for human praise.

There are many verses of the Bible, stories and illustrations that show God's intense displeasure towards pride and the fruits it bears. One of such scriptures is 1 Pet. 5:5b **"God resisteth the proud, and giveth grace to the humble."**

This is a sharp written verdict concerning God's primary judgement on the proud. That, it is God Himself who stands in the way of the proud, to impede his progress, for his end result will be to take the glory that belongs to God, and God will not let it happen. Then, the other end of the scripture explains how God empowers the humble unto progress and advancement in what he does, for God knows that, it is all unto His glory. In another scripture, it says that ***"God exalts the humble."*** (1Pet. 5:6) This and more shows how much God cherishes humility and the humble, and he is not afraid to elevate them, for they are carriers of His glory. Therefore, it is really wise to be humble.

The following are wisdom indices that measure humility in a person.

1. **Teachability and willingness to learn**: a humble person always maintains a posture of being ready to learn even from people she might be above. 1Cor. 8:2 paints this posture beautifully "And if any man think that he knoweth anything, he knoweth nothing yet as he ought to know." A humble person is always open to listen.

2. **Submissiveness to Authority:** A very key index of measuring humility is a person's relationship with authority. Proud people always have problems with authorities. Humble people are able to be under authority and submit and also use authority boldly and for the good of others when in authority.

3. **Relationship with correction:** A proud man thinks so highly of himself, he believes he knows how best to do what he does, and it will be an insult to him if anyone finds a fault in it, then tries to correct him. But a humble man is not so, being in a posture of teachability, he does what

he does and he's even open to know a better way of which it can be done; so, he receives every correction with gratitude. A humble man can be easily led out of an erroneous path, and led into a path wherein he should go, just because he is ever willing to embrace corrections. But for the proud man it is not so, for the Bible even declared it ***"Pride goeth before destruction"*** (Prov. 16:18), for he gave no room for correction.

4. **Meekness:** the ability to be doing a lot, yet saying little. A humble man is engrossed in doing more to get much more that he does not even have the time to make a noise of himself. He is never under pressure to show off his results so as to win accolades and respect. For such a man, it is the benefactors of his impact that noise him abroad, he is never arrogant nor puffed up by what he has amassed, for his heart is never in those things. He is meek, gentle and noble, in speech and conduct.

CHAPTER 22

THE WISDOM OF HONOUR

Honour is the recognition, acknowledgement and reward of a person's value, contribution, role and worth. Honour, like gratitude, must be expressed for it to be truly called honour. Honour is a thing of the heart and like, infatuation, it cannot be hidden. So God described certain people and said, these people come near to me with their mouth and honour me with their lips, but their hearts are far from me (Isa 29:13, Matt 15: 9, Mk 7:6). The truth is a person with sound judgement and discretion can discern both honour and dishonour from a mile away. Do not dishonour people and do not be comfortable with being dishonoured. Dishonour is unprofitable both to the giver and the recipient. Avoid dishonour from the giving and receiving side.

The uncomfortable truth is that for every incessant struggle and failure in a life, there is a principle or person they are dishonouring. If a bad situation refuses to change despite all odds, there is an element of dishonour contributing to its perpetuation. I have seen poor people being invited to buy a book or pay for a seminar, or sometimes, attend a conference where a rich person wants to speak and they refuse. Some say that 'is he going to give me money there?' That is gross dishonour for all the knowledge, value and results that person has. The little person that honours the great and overlooks their excesses to pursue all they represent will soon be great. There are sick people that count it too inconvenient to go and attend a meeting where a truly anointed servant

of God is ministering. Some sick people find it unnecessary to heed the doctor's advice. Check every area of your life where there is a challenge and look up to the person around you or a principle that you have neglected long enough, that might just be the solution. Going the extra mile to seek a person or thing is a proof of honour. Some men climbed a roof, tore it open and got their sick friend to Jesus when everywhere was blocked and Jesus did not see it as violence but honour for him so he healed the man. It amazes me how some people that have something to receive or learn from a greater person behave as if the greater should be the one seeking them. It is gross dishonour for the value that person has to offer you. An evidence of honour is pursuit.

What one does not honour, one cannot have and even if one has it, he will soon lose it. It is through honour you get access to greatness and through honour one sustains greatness. In 1 Sam 2:30-31, God spoke to some who displayed dishonour, ***"Therefore, the Lord, the God of Israel, says: I promised that your branch of the tribe of Levi would always be my priests. But I will honor those who honor me, and I will despise those who think lightly of me".*** Dishonour is a sin - it is the twin brother of pride. God hates them both and does not tolerate dishonourable people in His exalted place.

It is important that you honour all men that you relate with. It is easier for many to honour people above them but the true test of honour is how you honour those who are below you. 1 Peter 2:17 says, ***Honour all men. Love the brotherhood. Fear God. Honour the king.*** This shows there is the honour you accord to all humans as a basic right and there is the honour you accord to the king (leader) because he is above you. Therefore, it is right to honour every person you come across whether your superior, colleague or subordinate and there is an additional

honour you give to someone because they are your superior. So, a wise person looks beyond the present state of people and discerns the value to honour. Make honouring people a core value of your life as the Bible also instructs in Rom. 12:10 ***"Love one another with brotherly affection. Outdo one another in showing honor."***(ESV).

If it is wisdom to honour, then it is foolishness to dishonour. Dishonour is the lack of recognition, condescension or pursuit of a grace or value that has the ability to add to you. To dishonour is to build a wall of barrier between you and what the person has to add to you. Dishonour is also sowing a seed, but a seed unto unproductivity, lack and lowliness. Whatever is dishonoured depreciates and whatever one does not honour cannot do one any good. Thus, nothing or no one can benefit you if you dishonour them in your heart. This is the reason many people are in a place and are not making headway there. You cannot dishonour your pastor, spouse, parent or boss in your heart and wonder why their presence is not benefiting you. Conversely, you cannot be a sustainable blessing to someone or in a place you are dishonoured. This is the reason it is wisdom to humbly withdraw from places and people where you are treated dishonourably as it would be mutually non-beneficial for such a relationship to continue. If I cannot benefit you since you dishonour me and I also depreciate because I am dishonoured, then both of us would lose in the relationship - it is better I walk away.

The first level of honour should be unto God. Prov. 3:9-10 records, ***"Honour the LORD with thy substance, And with the firstfruits of all thine increase: So shall thy barns be filled with plenty, And thy presses shall burst out with new wine."*** We must honour God with all our heart and life. Honouring the Lord involves living a life that pleases him in all

holiness and godliness, it includes giving to Him and devoting your time to worship and serve Him.

The second level of honour is unto men. Among men, the first command of honour is to our parents - biological and spiritual. Ex. 20:12 ***"Honor your father and your mother, that your days may be long in the land that the Lord your God is giving you."*** Many people do not realise that honouring older people even when they are not your parents is also a scriptural command: ***'You shall rise before the gray headed and honor the presence of an old man, and fear your God: I am the Lord***. Lev 19:32

It is also important to honour your spouse, do not be too familiar with your spouse to the point of dishonour; a lasting marriage is built on the framework of mutual honour. We should only get married to a person who discerns our value and honours it. 1 Peter 3:7 says, ***Likewise, ye husbands, dwell with them according to knowledge, giving honour unto the wife, as unto the weaker vessel, and as being heirs together of the grace of life; that your prayers be not hindered*** and Eph. 5:33 says, ***"However, let each man of you [without exception] love his wife as [being in a sense] his very own self; and let the wife see that she respects and reverences her husband [that she notices him, regards him, honors him, prefers him, venerates, and esteems him; and that she defers to him, praises him, and loves and admires him exceedingly].*** So, the husband is to honour the wife and the wife is to honour the husband. We must doubly honour our pastors and spiritual leaders. This is shown in 1 Tim 5: 17; ***"Let the elders who rule well be considered worthy of double honor, especially those who labor in preaching and teaching. " (1Tim.5:17).*** It is also important to honour places. Honour the house of God, honour the place where you are being developed and built, honour your church and your place

of work, even if you think the pay is little. It is where you honour that you will prosper.

The way to reap honour is to sow it. For every seed of honour sown, there will be a harvest of honour. Also, we must conduct ourselves with honour so that we can be accorded due honour. It is wise to conduct ourselves, our businesses, our platforms and careers honourably so that people will look up to us and believe in us. Do you know that people only follow someone they honour? If they are following when there is no honour in their heart, they are merely acting up. So, in building honour, you have to pay attention to yourself. Have a good self-perception about yourself, be conscious of the values you have and carry yourself with high esteem and self-honour. The next thing is to pay attention to your affairs and dealings with people, in conversations, conduct and actions. Another thing is to give priority to your physical outlook, your grooming and appearance. You must be well packaged and branded. These are ways of building up yourself in honour, so that people can perceive you in that light and accord honour to you and to whatever you do.

CHAPTER 23

THE WISDOM OF ASSOCIATION

The relationships around you are an adequate measure and an accurate prediction of the level of your wisdom and the quality of your persona. People who have a good number of high quality persons as the reciprocal relationships in their immediate networks are those who have capacity and value themselves. If you want to have a fair guess at the quality of character, capacity, competence and value, check the reciprocal relationships in your life. A reciprocal relationship is one in which the person is interested in you and you are interested in them. A reciprocal relationship is not parasitic and is not one in which you are clinging to or pursuing someone who only does not know how to do away with you. A reciprocal relationship is a symbiotic relationship and there is mutual derivation of value and reciprocal respect.

Great people do not spend time with nonentities. Thus, if you are in a network of 10 mediocre persons, you are the eleventh, no rocket science about that. One of the surest ways to change your life is to change your associations. Proverbs 13:20 says, **He that walks with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed.** The person who associates with the great stands a great chance to be great.

You must be deliberate in choosing the relationships in your life. There should be an invisible circle around your space with an invisible door that determines who you let in and who you do not.

While we are to be loving and friendly to everyone, know today that you cannot give everyone access to yourself. The people you listen to and relate with are the greatest determinant of who you are becoming in life. This includes the church you attend, the school you go to, the colleagues you work with, the books you read, the movies you watch, the people you follow on social media. The law of association is all encompassing.

Jesus wanted to choose the twelve people that would be closest to Him in His earthly walk and spent an entire night praying. This shows us that we must be prayerful and spiritually sensitive in deciding who we allow to cross from one level of relationship to another with us. There are different levels of relationships in a person's life. There are strangers, acquaintances, friends and family, inner circles and confidants. Do not give people a place they do not belong with you. The rules of relating with people at these levels are different. You have to pray before allowing people into certain levels of your life space.

The difference between you today and tomorrow is your association. This is the reason you need to be deliberate in going after advantageous relationships. Relationships with great people are an asset. You need godly, successful and rich people in your life. Pray for God to send such people to your life. Develop yourself so that you will be valuable enough to have a reciprocal relationship with such people. Remember; help the poor, love them sincerely and don’t despise them but partner with the rich. Partnering and walking with the poor is dangerous foolishness.

It is utmost foolishness to give everybody equal access to yourself. The higher you go or you are working to go in life, the more streamlined the

people who make it into your inner circle becomes. An amazing folly I have witnessed so many times is how close relationships just metamorphose without intentional and careful thought in some people's life. You don't evolve into friendship with people, you choose the person you want to become friends with and the person you will never allow friendship with. The height of this folly is seen in how many marital relationships evolve out of emotional and sexual chemistry without deep and intentional mutual considerations and analysis. It sure takes more than 'shapely' bodies or 'baritone voice' for someone to be allowed to become the closest person to you in the entire universe. That is a sacred place and trust that should be earned.

I have seen students locked in the same room with a destructive relationship for an entire year in the name of school accommodation. What happened to selecting a wise person like you and putting money together to rent an apartment together? The level of closeness that living in the same room with someone brings should not be left to chance. I personally would not want to sleep in the same room with a fool for a whole year. How much more a lifetime, so why would you marry someone that you have not tested and proven their wisdom, godliness, vision, character and depth of value. TPT Proverbs 19:13 **says a rebellious son breaks a father's heart, and a nagging (foolish) wife (husband too) can drive you crazy!** (additions are mine)

In discussing the wisdom of association, marital choice is vital. While all associations must be chosen with great wisdom, your marriage affiliation is a killer or maker in life. The quality and calibre of the man or woman you marry is a direct reflection of the level of your wisdom (at least as at the time you were making that decision). Proverbs 19:14, **you can inherit houses and land from your parents, but a good wife**

only comes as a gracious gift from God! (TPT). This shows the need to pray in choosing a wife or husband because it can only come from God. However, a good friend, a valuable employee, a good mentor, a right business partner, and every other beneficial relationship come from God. So, don't ignore understanding the importance of praying about the relationships in your life when it concerns wife or husband, know that it is a principle that is applicable to all associations in your life.

CHAPTER 24

THE WISDOM OF PARENTING

There is a huge difference between being a parent and progenitor. This is because it is not biological procreation that confers parenthood. It is a mindset and practice of nurturing. The word 'Father' in the Greek is the word 'Pater'. It means source, nurturer, origin and principal/leader. The purpose of fatherhood is foremost to transfer nature and DNA to an offspring and thereafter nurture it to its full potential. Paternity is the ability to impart a nature on another and nurture that nature till full stature.

Nature and stature, nurtured by a parent, is not limited to the physical, it includes the spiritual, intellectual, academic, financial and other vital areas of life. Thus, the offspring of a billionaire is automatically a rich child and the offspring of an academician stands every chance of being academically advantaged. Thus, a major role of parenthood is to transfer the possibility and potentials to another and thereafter raise that person till they become and attain that potential. Exceptional parents nurture offspring who surpass them in nature. In other words, a good parent raises children that are better and greater than them in their area of advantage. This shows that how well you perform as a parent in an area of life is measured eventually by your children's attainment not merely yours. However, your children's attainment will eventually be determined - strengthened or weakened by your development in that area of life.

Parenthood is a huge demand and responsibility. A parent is pushing and gunning for more in life because they realise that what they become will be their children's life advantage or otherwise. The foremost wisdom of parenthood is preparation in capacity building - spiritually, mentally, academically, financially and emotionally.

Gen 4:20-21 talks about ***Jabal who was the father of such as dwell in tents, and of such as have cattle. And his brother, Jubal who was the father of all such as handle the harp and organ.*** Jabal was the first person to domesticate human living and animal rearing. Before him, all humans were wanderers, hunters and food-gatherers, with a nomadic lifestyle. He parented a generation of people who lived an established home life. His brother, Jubal, was the first musician in human history and parented a generation of musician. The normal rule of life is that your children stand every chance of becoming what you are. There are exceptions to this rule but we don't build principles on exceptions, we build on the rule. This profound wisdom is what singles need so as to be conscious that when they are choosing a spouse, they are actually choosing a nature, potential and a future for their children. In choosing a marital partner, don't just be focused on choosing a spouse for yourself, consider strongly the fact that you are choosing a parent for your children as well. The traits and lifestyle you would want to see in your children is what you look for in a spouse.

Many people are not building the capacity to be parents. unmarried, married or single parents, the growth and development in parenthood capacity must still continue. The truth is that God, in His predestination, many times allocates children to selected parents based on the destiny He has chosen for such unique children by His election of grace.

This selection is based on God's knowledge of the life and capacity of those parents. It is not everybody that can parent a Jesus, John the Baptist or father a nation He wants to get into covenant with. One of the reason God selected Abraham as the parent of His covenant nation in the Old Testament was recorded in Gen 18: 19, ***For I know him, that he will command his children and his household after him, and they shall keep the way of the Lord, to do justice and judgment; that the Lord may bring upon Abraham that which he hath spoken of him***.

It is a noble aspiration to become the kind of parent that God can trust with children He wants to do great and mighty things with. Therefore, it is wise to start praying for yourself and the kind of children you want God to give you even before you give birth. Whether you already have children or not, start laying up prayer capital for your children. If you are already a parent, your number one duty is to stand in the place of prayers over them. Send prayers ahead of them in life so that they will cross milestones with ease when they get there. Don't let them get to some places in life and start fighting spiritual warfare, send prophetic words and prayers ahead before they get there. It is wise to start laying hands on your children and declaring the words of God for their lives over them even right from the womb.

Good parents seek to lay up an inheritance for their children. ***Prov. 13:22 says, a good man leaveth an inheritance to his children's children . .*** Vital inheritances to leave include a spiritual heritage of knowledge and love for God, a legacy of a good name and goodwill as well as material and financial estates. Laying up inheritance for children is a deliberate effort that takes diligence and sacrifice. This includes living in a way that your life, achievement and the name you have earned poses an advantage to your children in the future.

The testimony of Timothy is that his mother and grandmother instilled scriptures and godliness into him from childhood so he grew up to become a mighty minister of God right from his teenage years till he died a very old man. 2 Tim 3:15 records about him, ***You have been taught the holy Scriptures from childhood, and they have given you the wisdom to receive the salvation that comes by trusting in Christ Jesus*** and 2 Tim 1:5 ***explained that it was proper parenthood that produced the renowned Timothy***, ***I remember your genuine faith, for you share the faith that first filled your grandmother Lois and your mother, Eunice. And I know that same faith continues strong in you.***

One of the spiritual duties of a parent is to declare blessings on their children. Do not just provide food, clothing and shelter for your children, provide a spiritual advantage for them by speaking words of blessing over them daily. A parent must never open their mouth to speak something negative to their children. Parents' word controls the course of the lives of their children.

Gen 27:37-39, ***And Isaac answered and said unto Esau, Behold, I have made him thy lord, and all his brethren have I given to him for servants; and with corn and wine have I sustained him: and what shall I do now unto thee, my son? And Esau said unto his father, Hast thou but one blessing, my father? bless me, even me also, O my father. And Esau lifted up his voice, and wept. And Isaac his father answered and said unto him, Behold, thy dwelling shall be the fatness of the earth, and ...KJV.***

Do not be a parent that has put your children at a disadvantage in life by the reason of the disempowering utterances that they have released in the children's direction. Always bless, do not curse.

Parenthood is not limited to your biological children alone. You must strive to be a parent to an entire generation. While you may not adopt everyone or make them stay under your roof, you can take up some people as spiritual children and protégés you raise in life. Therefore, take up children that do not have the privilege of proper parenting and become the role model and parental cover for them. There are many people that are struggling through life due to lack of proper parenting, you can allow God to use you as the parent they need.

CHAPTER 25

THE WISDOM OF SECRECY

Sometimes, silence is the greatest expression of wisdom. A young boy was shown a picture of his enviable future. He woke up from his sleep, perplexed, he couldn't understand nor read meaning to this baffling vision he saw. In his restlessness, he couldn't keep the door of his mouth; his naivety and curiosity drove him to his elder brothers, he narrated his dream to them, and they, being elderly could deduce that his dream is supposed to be a prophecy of his future superiority over. They hated him, envied and despised him. This young boy unwittingly opened up himself to a life of loneliness, rejection and persecution because he was void of wisdom at that time. (see Genesis 37:1-11) Very few things are more foolish and more devastating in life than telling things about yourself to a person(s) that you are not supposed to. The Wisdom of Secrecy is an advanced course in the school of wisdom.

The Wisdom of Secrecy is the art of knowing what to say, when to say it and to whom it is to be said to. This wisdom is so important to have that the psalmist prayed earnestly to God in Psalms 141:3**" LORD, set a guard over my mouth; keep watch over the door to my lips".** Many glorious destinies have been aborted because of indiscretion in revealing things to a person that shouldn't have known of it. In the Bible, Saul went looking for his father's missing donkey and the search led him to Prophet Samuel's house where he was told he would be the next king and even anointed for it.

When he got back home and the people got wind that he had the privilege to meet with the great Prophet Samuel, they were curious to know what the man of God told him. In 1 Sam 10: 15 - 16, ***Saul's uncle said, tell me what Samuel said to you. Saul replied, 'He assured us that the donkeys had been found." But he did not tell his uncle what Samuel had said about the kingship (NIV).*** What a great display of wisdom! He was given some information by the Prophet; he knew which was for public consumption, and which was for his private keep. This wisdom secured him till he ascended the throne and the prophecy was fulfilled. He kept details of his revealed future even from some people because he was wise enough to discern that in this case, "a man's enemies may be the men of his own house."

Lack of the wisdom of secrecy opens one up to wrong counsel. Do you know that most of the people who gave you wrong counsel were people that had no business being told about the situation actually? This was the plight of Rehoboam, the Son of Solomon a young king in the Bible. It is amazing how children of very wise people could be very foolish. So make sure you teach people around you wisdom and don't assume it will automatically rub off on them. He consulted two categories of people on an issue but he couldn't discern the right counsel to heed and whose counsel to avoid. He followed wrong counsel from his friends and destroyed the kingdom his fathers built for years (See 1 Kings 12:8-16). He should not have discussed the issue with his friends.

It is not friendship or courtesy that dictates who you tell things about yourself, it is discretion.

In 1 Kings 13, a young prophet was given a public message to go and deliver in a city and a private instruction not to eat in the city or come

back the same route he went. He delivered both the public message and the private instruction to everyone. It was the details of the private instruction that the older prophet that masterminded his death used to destroy him. So, this implies that biological age or cultural respect should not be the primary reason why you should give people the details of your destiny and access to counsel you, but rather, you should be led by the Spirit of God and be discerning by the Spirit of Wisdom to know who deserves and who does not deserve to know things about you. It is not everyone that has the right counsel for your specific situation. Thus, you have to discern through wisdom and prayer who God wants you to talk to in a particular situation.

The Lord Jesus Christ always knew what about Him was for private keep and for public consumption. So in several places in the Bible, he would do or say things, even good things, and would tell his disciple to make sure no one knows about it. In some cases, he will take the three most trusted out of all his disciples and allow only them to see or hear certain things about him. There are many other occasions in the Bible where Jesus would heal privately and instruct the healed not to go around telling everyone what he has done. He did this to teach them a powerful lesson of being discreet about what God was doing in their lives per season. While it is good to share testimonies of God's goodness, it is wise to discern what to share and what to keep to yourself. It is not every breakthrough you have that is meant for the social media.

The Wisdom of Secrecy is a necessary virtue for preservation of destiny.

Exercise

Mention 3 cases where you told people things that you wish you did not

1. Name of people
   - What you told them
   - Incurred consequence
   - lesson learnt

2 Identify 3 things you know God has told you or you know and you know is not for public consumption

3. Mention 2 persons you believe deserve to know details you do not tell others and identify the reason you think they deserve this place in your life.

CHAPTER 26

THE WISDOM OF UTTERANCE

It is wisdom to keep quiet when you should keep quiet and it is wisdom to speak when you should speak. Knowing the what, when and how of making utterance correctly is one of the highest indices of wisdom. You must make it an ambition to always know what to say and the right time to say it. People have gotten into trouble by what they said even more than by what they did. Utterance, many times, implicates people more than actions.

Words are actually meant to be for communication and also to disseminate information, but it is not everything that is meant to be verbalised. Silence, gesture, countenance, disposition are all forms of communication. So wisdom of utterance is knowing what type of utterance is best at a particular time.

For an intention to be verbalized, utterances have to be made. So verbalisation is crucial in communication. Thus, maximise your right and freedom to speak, but understand that one can either speak his way to life or speak his way to death. Prov. 18: 21 says, ***Death and Life are in the power of the tongue, and those who love it will eat its fruit.*** The truth is that people speak, but only few speak as guided by the wisdom of utterance. The wisdom of utterance is the wisdom to know what to say, when to speak, how to present it, to whom to speak to/with and if need be, when to keep silent.

It is also important to know that Satan, demons and wicked people do not know so much about you; they mostly depend on your utterance to deduce facts about you. So, make it your commitment to keep them clueless about your destiny and situations by relying completely on the Holy Spirit to be the gatekeeper of your mouth, and let the Word of God be your default utterance at the face of occurrences.

This Wisdom of utterance is the ability to speak the right words at the right time, and present your utterances in the right manner. Proverbs 16:23 (AMP) ***says, the mind of the wise instructs his mouth, and adds learning and persuasiveness to his lips.*** This shows that a wise person does not just speak because he feels like speaking or he is asked to, he speaks only as instructed by spiritual, emotional and mental intelligence. Always intelligently weigh the consequences of your utterances before you make them. A wise person knows the consequence of every utterance and only speaks for intended consequence.

Another key component of the Wisdom of Utterance is speaking boldly when you need to. Declaring spiritual words over physical realities is spiritual wisdom. You should not keep your mouth closed in spiritual warfare. Putting the Word of God on your lips and declaring it boldly in the face of contrary is wisdom. If Satan, situations or the enemy says anything contrary to you, it is not wisdom to keep quiet. Decree back what you want to see, that daring utterance is wisdom. In spiritual warfare, utterance is a necessity. Discretion in speech is needed before men but in the realms of the spirit, the wisdom of utterance is demonstrated by bold speaking and daring declarations. Ultimately, the utterance is only available through yielding to the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit prompts you on when to speak and when to be quiet.

The Bible says in Proverbs 25:11 ***"The right word spoken at the right time is as beautiful as gold apples in a silver bowl."*** This literally means, words could be "mud" when spoken at the wrong time; but by rightness of timing, it becomes gold. You must daily pray and yield to the Holy Spirit for the Wisdom of utterance. If the Holy Spirit prompts you to preach to your unbelieving boss about salvation, then that is the wisest thing you can do. It may look unprofessional and you may be afraid of the consequences but if you refrain, you might have just missed the last opportunity for your boss to hear and get saved. The truth is that the wisdom of utterance is not something that can be calculated or captured in a formula. Even though there are general principles, it is a wisdom that ultimately comes by walking with God and allowing the Holy Spirit to man the opening and closing of your oral cavity.

God is ever committed to guiding your destiny into fulfilment, but it is your responsibility to yield as He moves you to speak and to be silent. This is one of the competitive advantages that believers have over the unbelievers, we have the Holy Spirit to guide us to know what to say, how to say it and when to say it. So, we can speak ourselves into favour, promotion, prosperity, and all manners of help, just because we are right in time with our utterances. What is the wisest way to engage the wisdom of utterance? Lean on the Holy Spirit to know what to say, when to say it and how to say it and even what not to say when dealing with men. Then when dealing with situations, demonic forces, powers of darkness and enemies, just put the word of God in your mouth and boldly decree it to the situation.

Exercise

Write 2 laws that will govern the following areas of your utterance

(i) What you say about yourself

(ii) How you correct people publicly

(iii) How you make contributions to subjects in public

(iv) Who you give counsel to

(v) How you to talk superiors

(vi) How you talk to subordinates

(vii) What and how you talk when angry

(viii) What and how you talk when excited

(ix) What you say when the truth is hard to tell

(x) How you talk to people who love and honour you the most

CHAPTER 27

THE WISDOM OF LOVE

Walking in wisdom is walking in love. Whenever one steps out of love, one steps into errors. Whenever you are faced with alternatives and a crisis of choices, it is helpful to always ask yourself, 'what would love do?' You cannot be wrong when you choose the way of love.

"*I can never be wrong when I choose the way of love".* I know a thousand and one people that followed the way of love and went wrong', someone might be quick to ask. They would further furnish examples of lovers that were cheated, broken, offended, taken for granted, or even destroyed. They would challenge the statement that " no one can be wrong following love". Well, the truth is that the people that went wrong following 'love' actually followed the 'wrong kind of love'. Certainly, you can never go wrong following the way of Real Love.

It is common knowledge that the word 'Love' as used in English has many equivalents in Greek, which is a language that offers a more nuanced vocabulary for describing different facets of love. For instance, in the Greek language, 'Agape' refers to unconditional or selfless sacrifice for the wellbeing of another. 'Philia' represents affection, fondness or friendly likeness for another. 'Storge' pertains to familiar or cordial love and solidarity, while 'Eros' signifies romantic, passionate or sexual attraction towards someone. All these words with widely divergent and varied meanings and applications are all translated 'Love'

in English. In fact, there are some other usages of the word love in English that have a different Greek word other than the four described above. The point is that the word 'love' in English has been so misused, misunderstood, and bastardised that it seems to have lost its power due to the fact that a lot of wrong labels have been placed on 'love'. Love can never go wrong or fail. Real love is Agape - the God-Kind of Love. Many things mislabelled as 'love' have all gone wrong and have given Love a bad name.

1 John 4:7-9 says, ***Beloved, let us love one another, for love is of God; and everyone who loves is born of God and knows God. He who does not love does not know God, for God is love.*** (NKJV). God is love! So, what God would do in every situation is what love would do. Do you now see that the way of love is the way of wisdom? When you are faced with a situation and you don't know how to react or what step to take, ask yourself; 'what would God do if He was in my shoes? How would Jesus react if He was here? What God would have done is the way of love - Choose that way and you would have acted wisely.

In Mark 12:28-31, One of the teachers of religious law was standing . . . so he asked, ***"Of all the commandments, which is the most important?" Jesus replied, "The most important commandment is this: 'Listen, O Israel! The LORD our God is the one and only LORD. And you must LOVE the LORD your God with all your heart, all your soul, all your mind, and all your strength.' The second is equally important: 'LOVE your neighbor as yourself.' No other commandment is greater than these."*** Love is the greatest instruction, so Love is the greatest wisdom.

According to Rom 13:9-10, For the commandments, ***"Do not commit adultery, do not murder, do not steal, do not covet,"***

(and if there is any other commandment) are summed up in this, "Love your neighbor as yourself." Love does no wrong to a neighbor. Therefore love is the fulfillment of the law. It is important to know that the person who walks in the God-Kind of Love lives above the legalistic demands of the law. He/she seeks the best for everyone, so desires to do no one any wrong.

Before Christ, the people did not have the "Love Nature" in them so God needed to regulate every bit of their actions and decisions through commandments of right and wrong, dos and don'ts. The believer has the Love of God and is to be ruled and regulated by Love. The Law of Love is God's wisdom and regulation to make sure we live life right.

The book of 1 Corinthians 13 is the classic on the attributes of love. ***It says, Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast, it is not proud. It does not dishonor others, it is not self-seeking, it is not easily angered, it keeps no record of wrongs. Love does not delight in evil but rejoices with the truth. It always protects, always trusts, always hopes, always perseveres. Love never fails. But where there are prophecies, they will cease; where there are tongues, they will be stilled; where there is knowledge, it will pass away*** (1 Cor 13: 4 - 8). Many taking these verses as the working definition of Love exclude what many people term 'Love'.

Love is the most powerful force in the universe. The reason love has seemed weak in the face of many situations is because most of the contexts where the word 'Love' is used, 'Real Love' is absent. Mark you, 'Real Love' not a romantic terminology, neither is it a feeling or an emotion. Real Love is a divine nature governed by an understanding powering deliberate courses of action and decision.

Love is very intentional in its actions; therefore, it chooses to respond in specific ways irrespective of the situation. It chooses to respond with what is best for the other party even if it demands sacrifice on one's part.

Thus, a lover is not the boy that is in love with a girl or the girl that falls in love with a boy; a true lover loves people generally. Many times, the noble actions of romantic love are born out of vested interest in the object of 'love' and are transactional investments for intended gain. Thus, when you want to know a true lover, do not examine how they 'love' one person they have an emotional interest in, check their love nature and love walk towards everyone they meet in daily life. Actually, the concept of falling in love as the world practices it, is foreign to God, Scripture enjoins us to stand in love, not fall into it. This shows that love is a sane course of action chosen intentionally per time, not some uncontrollable emotional frenzy.

Love is an eternal, life-giving, life-changing power. The Wisdom of Love starts with loving God, people, oneself and it extends to loving what you do and loving life. You should be a walking ball-fire radiating love. The wisdom of love goes beyond loving people to loving things. Therefore, pour your love and passion into your life assignment and work. Love is the seed for impact and greatness. You cannot impact positively a person or system you do not love. You cannot become great in what you do not love.

Have you seen a very skilled musician that hates music before or the world footballer of the year that hates football? So, one cannot be a good leader unless one genuinely loves people.

There are heights in life attainment that one cannot get to unless love is involved. This is the error of supporting leaders who kill, steal and cheat to get into leadership position. They love position not people so they cannot put people first when they get to the place of leadership. It is not loving politics or being good at politics that makes great leaders; it is loving people because what you love you are wise in relating with.

CHAPTER 28

THE WISDOM OF GRATITUDE

There are some practices that are doses to live a happy and healthy life. These habits power up and secure a life of bliss, strength and hope. One of such practice is living a lifestyle of immense gratitude for every gift of life. Gratitude is an act that begins from a heart that recognizes a blessing, and then responds to that blessing by acknowledgement and appreciation. Grateful people are thoughtful people, who will look for a reason to give thanks, even in a seeming unpleasant situation, rather than being encumbered with worries and complaints. In positive psychology research, gratitude is strongly and consistently associated with greater happiness. Gratitude helps people feel more positive emotions, relish good experiences, improve their health, deal with adversity, and build strong relationships. Grateful people live under an atmosphere of hope, which make them immune to any dart of sorrow and grief life throws at them. A grateful person is not just grateful because every line is falling in right places; but even when things seem not to go as planned, they have a beautiful sigh of "it is well." to express. Gratitude stems from a depth of understanding that is rooted in the knowledge of God's goodness.

A simple utterance of "thank you" from a sincere heart can act as a catalyst to speed up a function and usher one into great success. Gratitude should be a language of communication between people in their various homes, workplaces and schools.

In an environment where gratitude is relatively expressed; relationships are strengthened, there is fostering of goodwill, and promotion of positive emotions. Gratitude is a strong index to measure one's spiritual, mental, emotional and social health. In an atmosphere of expressive gratitude, there is multiplication and preservation. Thanksgiving secures the received blessing and procures the favour to receiving more blessings.

God is good and rich unto all, but He is unapologetically gracious to people who have mastered the art of thanking Him for every little thing in their lives. In the Bible, there are many cases of people whose lifestyle of gratitude to God made them highly preferred above their peers, prolonged their lives, multiplied their resources, fortified their camps and engendered God's power to turn hopeless situation around. One of such occurrences is seen in the book of 2Chronicles 20: 1-25 "(vs. 21:) ***And when he had consulted with the people, he appointed singers unto the Lord, and that should praise the beauty of holiness, as they went out before the army, and to say, Praise the Lord; for his mercy endureth for ever.***" In a situation that seems defeat and destruction is imminent, the wisdom of gratitude teaches to look away from the tempestuous wind of life and set one's gaze on Jesus only, giving thanks and reassuring oneself of His steadfast love and unfailing mercy.

Apostle Paul in the New Testament exhorts in 1Thess. 5:16-18 "***Rejoice always, pray continually, give thanks in all circumstances; for this is God's will for you in Christ Jesus.***" This is to say that circumstances and situations should not determine a believer's posture, but that he should be proactively joyous and thankful in any and all circumstances. The stance of a believer should be of a posture that expresses the goodness and faithfulness of God through thanksgiving.

A settled understanding that "***The LORD is good; His mercy endures forever, and His faithfulness to all generations.***" (Ps. 100:5) A believer should be firmly rooted in the conviction that at all times, God cannot but be good. So, in the midst of chaos, afflictions and perils, a believer is kept in an unwavering peace that God is good.

Gratitude should first be of a heart posture, which is enriched with the knowledge of God's goodness and faithfulness across generations; a heart full of meditations on the mighty demonstration of God's power in and through the lives of His faithful servants, in the holy scriptures. Then, there should be an outflow of gratitude from such heart through the fruits of one's lips. Heb. 10:15 **"By him therefore let us offer the sacrifice of praise to God continually, that is, the fruit of our lips giving thanks to his name."** Gratitude is not received if it is not communicated, a grateful person must give a literal expression of his thankfulness to God, through words, songs, shouts, claps, dances and even through instruments of praise. God is delighted and pleased in a child who knows of the gracefulness of His father, and is generous to give Him praise, come what may.

Thankfulness and gratitude to God is beautiful, but it becomes hypocritical, when one is not thankful for and to the gift of men around a one's life. You cannot claim to be grateful to God when you are not grateful to the people He used for you. Just as we show our love for God by our love for people, we show gratitude to God also in appreciating people. Learn and master the habit of appreciating the good people in your life; parents, pastors, spouse, friends, colleagues, business partners, employees, boss and acquaintances. Also, be specific in appreciating people and don’t generalise people’s sacrifices to you. Never be so familiar with someone that you stop expressing your gratitude to them.

Give thanks for every little blessing including the blessing of good people.

We must also learn to be grateful to ourselves. Many times, we appreciate everyone else apart from ourselves. We must learn to celebrate and reward ourselves even if nobody else does. You have been working and driving yourself hard. It is time to say ‘thank you’ to yourself not just in words but in actions. Have you given yourself a good treat recently? You sure deserve one from yourself

CHAPTER 29

THE WISDOM OF PRAYER

There are many diligent and fervid labourers in various spheres in the world today; building their lives, careers, businesses, ministries, industries, conglomerates; according to an idea or a plan they have devised in their minds; while working with the sure principles of life that procure success and greatness. However, not so many of these folks really amount to the weight of greatness they envisaged in their mind. Passion, diligence, consistency, followership, persistency, resilience, charisma, finesse, intelligence, skills; these and more are the effective keys that unlock greatness, and open one up to a life of beauty and splendour. However, all these keys without the master key of prayer will not produce the accurate results that match up with the effort invested and the work done; this then result in pain, disappointment and frustration.

Prayer stems from an understanding that even though nothing works unless somebody is working on it, there is also the need for a supernatural intervention that empowers one to sow and reap, even a hundredfold. Prayer is a conscious partnership with a spirit to bless the work of one's hands and multiply the results those hands produce. Wisdom principles are not substitutes for prayer; it is also wisdom to pray. And to balance up the square, prayer is also not a substitute for wisdom principles. Prayer is as well a wisdom principle as the others, and it is chiefly positioned because, it is not just a principle to add on

while building, but the principal principle to etch one's building from. The foundation of every magnificent building that would stand the test of time should be laid by the diligent hands of prayer. The architectural plan that anchors the building process should be fetched from the place of prayer. And as one brick is being laid upon another, prayer should be the cementing paste that binds and holds them all together.

Jesus Christ was not just a passionate advocate of prayer; he practically lived a life of prayer, in building up HIMSELF, his MINISTRY and setting OTHERS into purpose and fulfilment. ***"And in the morning, rising up a great while before day, he went out, and departed into a solitary place, and there prayed."*** (Mk. 1:35) Jesus devoted an ample part of his time to prayers, setting himself apart in solitude to build up himself, and to receive divine revelations and instructions from God, on what to do per time and season. So, prayer will first of all build you up, and then equip and empower you to build your life, destiny and vision. Men who are built up by prayer become strong and able men, who live above every limitation, brought down every stronghold of darkness and wrought great exploits as victors and conquerors. Men who pray, consistently evolve into the better version of themselves; for every second spent in prayer is an investment unto betterment, increase and expansion. The Bible clearly captured it in Jude 1:26 (Amp), ***"But you, beloved, build yourselves up [founded] on your most holy faith [make progress, rise like an edifice higher and higher], praying in the Holy Spirit;"*** Prayer is a builder. As one prays in the building language of the Spirit; there is constantly an upgrade. A small and fearful person can pray up himself into a strong giant, to do valiantly, and function in various dimensions of graces, as unlocked by prayers.

Then, what responsibility of destiny has God committed into your

hands? What assignment has God given to you? What vision has God revealed in your heart? What career has God given you as an ambition? What business idea has God ideated in your mind? What ministry has God ordained you for? PRAY! It is foolish to receive the blueprint of one's destiny from God and then start running with it by human philosophies and principles. The God who gave the architectural plan is also interested in the building process. And this is by prayer. "***O Lord, I know that the way of man is not in himself: it is not in man that walketh to direct his steps.***" (Jer. 10:23) When God shows the way, He is keenly interested in leading the way, and guiding one's feet step by step. A wise man understands that "***there is a way that seemeth right unto a man, but the end thereof are the ways of death.*** (Prov. 16:25) So, he depends on God completely to order his steps and to dictate his moves. And this is as he prays. Prayer is an enforcer by which one enforces the promises of God over one's life into reality. Prayer is also a means by which one tenders one's petitions before God, supplicating for His provisions in alignment with His Will for one's life.

And lastly, prayer sets up others into the discoveries of their purpose in God, and preserves them unto fulfilment. A person can pray another into the Will of God for their lives, insisting on the salvation of their souls and that they should respond to their high callings in God. This prayer is called the prayer of intercession; standing in gap for others to set them up for a life of godliness and glory. There is a portion in the scriptures that portrays intercession as an act of God's Love and mercy to restore men unto himself, by raising up other men to stand in gap for them. ***"I have set watchmen upon thy walls, O Jerusalem, which shall never hold their peace day nor night: ye that make mention of the Lord, keep not silence. And give him no rest, till he establish, and till he make Jerusalem a praise in the earth."*** (Isa. 62:6-7)

As believers, prayer is not a choice, it is not an option. Prayer should be our natural lifestyle. Jesus did not say "if" you pray as a function of your choice, but "when" you pray, as an expected way of living that one need not to be coerced or begged into. Prayer is man's will of acknowledging God as the planner, builder and rewarder of his destiny.

CHAPTER 30

THE WISDOM OF PROPHETIC BLESSINGS

It is great wisdom to position one's life for an operation under open heavens. 'Open Heavens' is a term generally used to describe a favourable spiritual climate over a person's life and destiny that makes the spiritual realm work in the person's advantage thereby producing desirable physical outcomes.

The truth is that, having engaged all the wisdom keys outlined in this book, it is important to note that the spiritual climate over a person's life and destiny is the ultimate determinant of their life results. The spiritual realm utterly controls the physical, and having done all that needs to be done in the natural, one must know how to engage available spiritual advantage.

At times, it is not merely the absence of doing the right things in the natural - all the things which have been largely portrayed in this book - that is responsible for the presence of certain life limitations. Many times, it is because there is something in the spiritual realm that needs to be engaged. The story of Job is a classic example of the hold the spiritual has over the physical. Job was successful, having all going well at a moment and the next moment, he was down to ashes. All this did not happen because he did anything differently in the natural realm but because a negotiation happened concerning him in the spiritual which he was even oblivion to.

The spiritual legislates over the natural at any time, on any day. Like Job, there are many people whose physical state is as a result of a spiritual transaction which they may not even be party in its negotiation. Spiritual intelligence and wisdom is knowing what to do to trigger the spiritual realm to work in one's advantage.

One among the key principles for engaging spiritual advantage is to have a voice that supplies prophetic cover and advantage to one's destiny. This means, it is wise to have a grace and voice you are connected and submitted to for prophetic blessings. It is important to have someone that is higher than you in the spirit that releases blessings over you and the work of your hand. You need to recognize the fathers, mothers, and spiritual authorities that God has set over you and position yourself for a continual flow of words of blessings in your direction from them. A word of wisdom, however, is to note that you should be led by God to the spiritual authority to submit your life under. It is not something to be window-shopped for or to be chosen based on likeness for a famous prophetic figure you seemingly admire. The prophet over your life that will have the right heart for you and the right words for your destiny in his/her mouth is usually a gift to be allocated by God to each individual.

In the Book of Ezra, the Jews were building the Temple, led by Zerubbabel the Governor of the land and Joshua the High Priest but Bible recounts that they succeeded because as some people were working physically, there were prophetic voices supplying spiritual backup to them. This is shown in Ezra 6: 14, ***'and the elders of the Jews builded, and they prospered through the prophesying of Haggai the prophet and Zechariah the son of Iddo. And they builded, and finished it, according to the commandment of the God of Israel, and according to the***

commandment of Cyrus, and Darius, and Artaxerxes king of Persia'
Generally, people prosper because there is a voice speaking in the realm of the spirit speaking on their behalf. The people of the world, the unbelievers and the practitioners of darkness understand this fact very well and they will seldom do anything until they have leveraged on spiritual advantage from their 'prophets of the realm of darkness.' It is children of God's kingdom that has been poisoned by the spirit of deception to despise their own prophets and pastors. No matter how great or kingly you are in the natural, your success is largely dependent on submission to a spiritual leader for continuous supply of spiritual grace, blessing and advantage. This is deep wisdom.

In the Old Testament, three categories of people were anointed over the nation of Israel: the king, the priests and the prophet. The king and priest provide executive, judicial and legislative leadership while the prophet provided spiritual leadership. The nation experienced blessings when the king submitted to the spiritual fatherhood and authority of a genuine prophet of God. The country experienced problems when the king rebelled against the instructions and spiritual cover of the prophet. The spiritual is superior to the natural. It does not matter your position in the natural, there must be a fountain of spiritual blessings that speaks over your life.

At certain points in the history of Israel, Samuel was Prophet over the nation. He released prophetic blessings over Saul as king and as long as the king submitted to his fatherhood and blessings, he reigned in prosperity. After Saul rebelled against his prophetic cover, God led Samuel to place the prophetic blessing on David. David lived his entire life under the prophetic blessing and fatherly covering. At a point when Saul was after his life, he ran to meet his spiritual father in Ramah.

According to 1 Sam 19:18-24, ***so David escaped and went to Ramah to see Samuel, and he told him all that Saul had done to him. Then Samuel took David with him to live at Naioth. When the report reached Saul that David was at Naioth in Ramah, he sent troops to capture him. But when they arrived and saw Samuel leading a group of prophets who were prophesying, the Spirit of God came upon Saul's men, and they also began to prophesy. When Saul heard what had happened, he sent other troops, but they, too, prophesied! The same thing happened a third time. Finally, Saul himself went to Ramah and arrived at the great well in Secu. "Where are Samuel and David?" he demanded. "They are at Naioth in Ramah," someone told him. But on the way to Naioth in Ramah the Spirit of God came even upon Saul, and he, too, began to prophesy all the way to Naioth! He tore off his clothes and lay naked on the ground all day and all night, prophesying in the presence of Samuel. The people who were watching exclaimed, "What? Is even Saul a prophet?"***

David ran under Samuel's prophetic cover when the battle became a life and death matter. The battle that seemed so great for David to fight proved to be too small for Samuel who did not even lift a finger but all the armies of Saul and eventually Saul himself were disgraced and fell under the power of God, the moment they came around the circumference of the spiritual atmosphere of Samuel where David hid. The issues that look like a big problem in your life may just need a simple word of prayer from a spiritual authority. However, the question is do you have one over your life that you are actively connected to?

When Samuel died, the Bible records King David's submission to the prophetic authority and cover of Prophet Nathan who was more of an age contemporary to King David (2 Sam. 7: 4, 2 Sam 12: 1). The truth is that prophetic cover is not by age, it is by grace.

You may be older or age-mate with someone, but if they rank higher than you in the spirit and God wants you to submit to them for a flow of prophetic blessings, please condescend and don't relate to your prophet as an equal.

Your destiny will always need prophetic help, so have a spiritual covering that can shield you in and out of seasons. Spiritual leaders are called fathers in the Old Testament and elders in the New. They are positioned to bring an advantage to your life and help you go farther in life. They are to provide a spiritual shield for you especially in tough seasons of life. The battle you have been fighting for long can be easily settled by prophetic intervention. This strategy is God's wisdom to keep His people humble and procure honour for His servants. Prophetic blessing can also be released by biological parents in addition to pastors and spiritual leaders. It is the principle of submission to authority for a flow of blessing. The blessing is stronger than curses. The reason curses have seemed strong is that we have not being well taught the principle of the blessing - the blessing from submission to someone you see as greater than you. Heb 7:7 says, ***'now beyond all contradiction the lesser is blessed by the greater'.***

While it is true that every child of God is blessed with every spiritual blessings in the heavenly realms (Eph. 1: 3) and has direct access to the blessing of Abraham through Jesus Christ (Gal 3: 14), God's systematized protocol of the blessing is that it is released upon a man and transferred from that man to every other person. This is the reason even Abraham the father of faith needed to be blessed by Melchizedek (Gen 14: 18 - 24). Jesus blessed the bread and gave it to the apostles to transfer to the Church (John 6: 11, Mark 14: 22- 24). This shows that there was no way to access the blessing of Jesus Christ except one

received it through his disciples then. The apostles have passed the message and the blessing over to many people and there are billions of people that have received the salvation and other blessings in Christ. However, the principle still remains the same - the only way to receive the blessing of God is through a man He has committed it to. This is the wisdom of God to humble all men as they cannot access Him completely independent of other people. The great disdain and dishonour that Satan has planted in the heart of people for Christian leaders, pastors and prophets by always propagating negative things about them is his strategy to attach this power of prophetic cover and blessings from them. This is because the blessing cannot flow to one from a carrier that one does not honour. Sadly, many Christians in ignorance are partners and propagators of Satan's work of attacking men of God. Please, desist from that foolishness, your prophetic advantage is in the mouth of a man of God.

CHAPTER 31

CONCLUSION - THE WISDOM OF ETERNITY

Classically, there are three orders of event in a man's life: his birth, his death and the life he lived in between; which then decides the life he would live after death. All through different ages and dispensations, ample and apt exegesis has been done on time and living in time. There are beautiful pieces of literature crafted by philosophers and theorists in a bid to define and give meaning to the verity of time and the reality of living. However, there hasn't been clarity and actual understanding of the essence of the life lived in time and of how it affects the life lived after time. And is it even true that there is some life after death? If there is, where is that location? How do we go there? What do we do there? What's it all about? These and many more are the myriad of questions asked by the inquisitive minds of men, but only project further confusions, because both the "what and how" of it is purely spiritual, and can be conceived and understood only by a spiritual mind. These vagueness and confusion is what the wisdom of eternity will by the Spirit, bring to light.

The first place where the word "eternity" was mentioned In the Bible (KJV) is in Isaiah 57:15a ***"For thus saith the high and lofty One that inhabiteth eternity, whose name is Holy; I dwell in the high and holy place"*** Herein, we understand that God lives and inhabits himself in eternity. What then is eternity? Eternity is a spiritual reality of a realm and existence that is beyond time.

This is to say that eternity is an infinite space that exists outside the circumference of time. It is a reality that cannot be measured by and in time. In comparison, time is a measurable and finite existence that is marked within the infinite and immeasurable existence called eternity. So, we can rightly deduce that man is a being set out of eternity to live in time for a definite period, and then having lived in time should exit out of time to continue into eternity. To come into time, is by being born to live for a while in time, and then to exit out of time through an event called death. So, since man is a being set out of eternity by God to live in time, then there will surely be a continuation of man's existence after his life in time, and that; is his return to God in eternity. This therefore justifies the reality of life after death.

The wisdom of eternity then teaches us to know that there is a direct implication of the life lived by man in time on the life man will live after time. A man's life should not just be lived as he wills nor as he pleases, but according to the will and for the pleasure of He who set him in time. This then explains the concept of purpose; that man does not just exist in time only to die after some while, but that man should live only to fulfil the purpose of why he exists in time.

God set man in time that he may carry out an assignment, fulfil a mission and then return to God to be rewarded for his work on earth. This means that man's life in time should be defined by his God-given and life assignment. And This assignment is contained, discovered and fulfilled. Because when man lost his compass and missed his way; God reached out to man through Jesus as the only true way to bring man back to himself. So, for man and his works to be accepted by God, he has to

be by his belief and confession of Jesus as Lord. Romans 10:9 ***"That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved."*** So, the only means by which man can fulfil his assignment and also by which his eternal reward can be guaranted is by coming into Jesus as the only true way to God. John 14:6 ***"Jesus saith unto him, I am the way, the truth, and the life: no man cometh unto the Father, but by me."***

In the world today, there are many religions and sects who in one way or the other believe that God is the object of their worship. They claim to be servants and followers of God, but outside of the lordship of Jesus. It's so unfortunate to see men labour religiously in good deeds and morality, but only unto futility and vanity. Because there are not many ways, but only one way to God, and that's through Jesus Christ. Acts 4:12 ***"There is salvation in no one else, for there is no other name under heaven given among men by which we must be saved."***

Jesus during his ministry on earth, through stories and parables, gave several accounts on the reality of life after death, and the aftermath of the kind of life a person lived while on earth. Jesus always had a common ending to those parables; as seen three times in the Gospel of Matthew (8:12, 22:13, and 25:30) ***"But the children of the kingdom (not of Christ) shall be cast out into outer darkness: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth."***

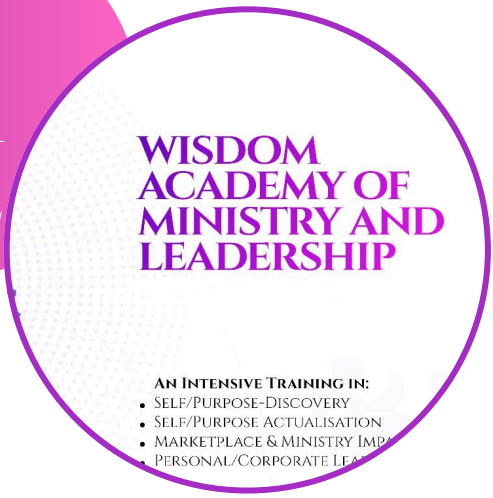
The wisest decision to make in life is the decision to secure one's eternity, through Jesus Christ. One day, this earth will end; time will cease to exist; nothing else will matter other than one's soul who will give account of one's lifetime, and then procures God's judgment, either to live with God forever or to be doomed unto eternal death and damnation. Jesus once asked a powerful question which every living

soul must answer, Mark 8:36-37 ***"For what shall it profit a man, if he shall gain the whole world, and lose his own soul? Or what shall a man give in exchange for his soul?"*** The decision to secure one's eternity should not be one to procrastinate, but to make just right NOW!!

To give your life to Jesus, say this prayer:

Lord Jesus, I believe in you as my Lord and Saviour. I ask that you come into my life and save my soul. I receive the Life of God, and I live for God alone. Henceforth, I am a child of God, and I reign over sin, sickness and death. Thank you Jesus for saving me, Amen!

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ABOUT THE BOOK

According to scriptures, Wisdom is the most important thing to get to ascertain a life of meaning, success and fulfilment. However, Wisdom is not unilateral but multifaceted and dynamic. Meaning that a person can be wise in an area of life and absolutely unwise in another. Furthermore, a person can be wise today and act with astounding foolishness tomorrow. Thus, knowing and practising wisdom everyday of life and in every area of life should not be left to chance. The 31 Wisdom Keys gives profound wisdom capsules for each day and spreads wisdom tentacles across all areas of life. This book will challenge you to live with the deliberate consciousness of applying wisdom in every area of your existence.



ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Davids Oluwaseye Ayodele is a trainer, speaker and writer. He is graced with understanding and presenting complex issues with simplicity and clarity for practical application.

He is the founder of several initiatives both within the church and the workplace, such as The Wisdom Institute of Leadership and Ministry for training and equipping church leaders, ENABLED Multiconcept for business and professional leadership development and consultancy, as well as several other platforms for Bible-based Teaching Ministry. He has a bachelor's degree in chemical engineering and a master's degree in engineering management from Ahmadu Bello University, Nigeria. He is married to Deborah OluwaNifemi and they are blessed with children.